

TOPIC 1: INTRODUCTION

Communication refers to **a process of giving, receiving or exchanging** (sharing) **information, opinions** (views, thoughts) **or ideas** (facts about something) **by writing, speaking or acting so that the message** (physical form, expressible) **communicated is understood by the recipient/ audience** (2 or more people).

Successful communication means that the transmitted message must be appropriately understood to achieve a common objective

It can be defined as the **process by which information is exchanged and understood by two or more people** usually with intention to influence behavior.

It is the transfer of information in form of understandable messages through a channel to others.

Everyday people are communicating whether it is talking on telephone, face-to-face, writing letters, e-mails etc. It is therefore essential that communication skills are enhanced.

IMPORTANCE OF COMMUNICATION.

- Aids decision making
- Promotes relationships among people
- Basis to analyze performance of organizations
- In solving problems-negotiation
- Motivate others
- Liaise with external stakeholders
- Team performance
- Organize human and other resources in the most effective way.
- Develop plans for the organization
- To inform members of changes in the Organization

METHODS / TYPES OF COMMUNICATION

When communicating there are several methods that can be used. Special care must be taken when deciding on which method to use. This is because once a wrong method is used it may have a disastrous effect. There are two major methods of communication and they are;

- 1) Verbal communication where we have (Oral and Written communication)
- 2) Non-verbal.

The Visual and Audio visual are used with the above major methods of communication.

Verbal Communication in simple terms is communication using words

Non-verbal communication in simple terms is communication using actions or communication wordless messages.

ORAL COMMUNICATION

This includes speaking to another person or communication by the word of mouth. It requires carefully selecting appropriate words as words **denotes** (dictionary/ actual meaning) and **connotes** (implied/ intended meaning) meaning.

Forms / means of oral communication

Over the telephone, face to face discussions, debates, interviews, presentations, meetings (formal or informal), teleconferencing, video conferencing etc. The success of verbal communication depends on one's ability to listen carefully.

Characteristics

Interactive, restricted audience, any time any place, immediate feedback,

N.B students should find the advantages and disadvantages

WRITTEN COMMUNICATION

This is when a message being sent is displayed in writing.

Forms / means of written communication

E-mails, letters, fax, notices, reports, memos, questionnaires, newsletter, employee hand books, magazines, brochures, minutes etc.

Its success depends on somebody's ability to read.

Characteristics

More detailed, records, formal, complex issues,

Non interaction, restrictive in use, no immediate feedback.

N.B students should find the advantages and disadvantages

NON-VERBAL

This is sending and receiving wordless messages. It can be used together with verbal and written methods and or alone.

Forms/ means

It's divided into 3, Environment, social and physical.

Characteristics

Widely used, unconscious communication, miss interpretation, security purposes,

N.B students should find the advantages and disadvantages

Others methods

Visual and Audio-visual communication-

They supplement both oral and written communication.

When information is displayed in various ways e.g. videos, tables, graphs, charts among others.

FACTORS TO CONSIDER WHILE CHOOSING A METHOD OF COMMUNICATION.

The method chosen when communicating is very crucial. Therefore, one needs to put into consideration several factors;

- **Recipient/ audience**-who is receiving the message (status), appropriate language, the situation at hand, relationship between the sender and the receiver.
- **Distance**-is it within or far away. If the distance is within you can choose oral and if it is far you can choose written.
- **Time** –when communicating overseas.
- **Urgency/ speed**-is it so urgent that you need feedback immediately
- **Cost**-affordability, how much will the communication cost. Choose what you can afford
- **Confidentiality**-e-mail or fax may not be appropriate; a telephone call could be overheard. Choose what is more confidential depending on your information.
- **Safety and security** choose the one that is more safer depending on the situation at hand
- **Availability of means** considers the means available
- **Nature of the msg (size)** if the message is detailed choose written if brief choose oral
- **Knowledge of the sender e.g** If the sender does not know how to read and write he or she will not choose written but will choose oral.
- **Influence**

TOPIC 2: EFFECTIVE COMMUNICATION

Objectives: The purpose is to become a better communicator through mastering correct self- expression in business communication both written and spoken. People remember more a good communicator than an excellent professional who communicates poorly. The message is said to be effective when the receiver understands the same meaning that the sender intended to convey. Many people make judgments about others based on how well they communicate hence the need to get your grammar right as early as possible. You can cause an irreversible situation if you do not get the language of business right i.e. send an unintended message.

The message is said to be effective when the receiver understands the same meaning that the sender intended to convey.

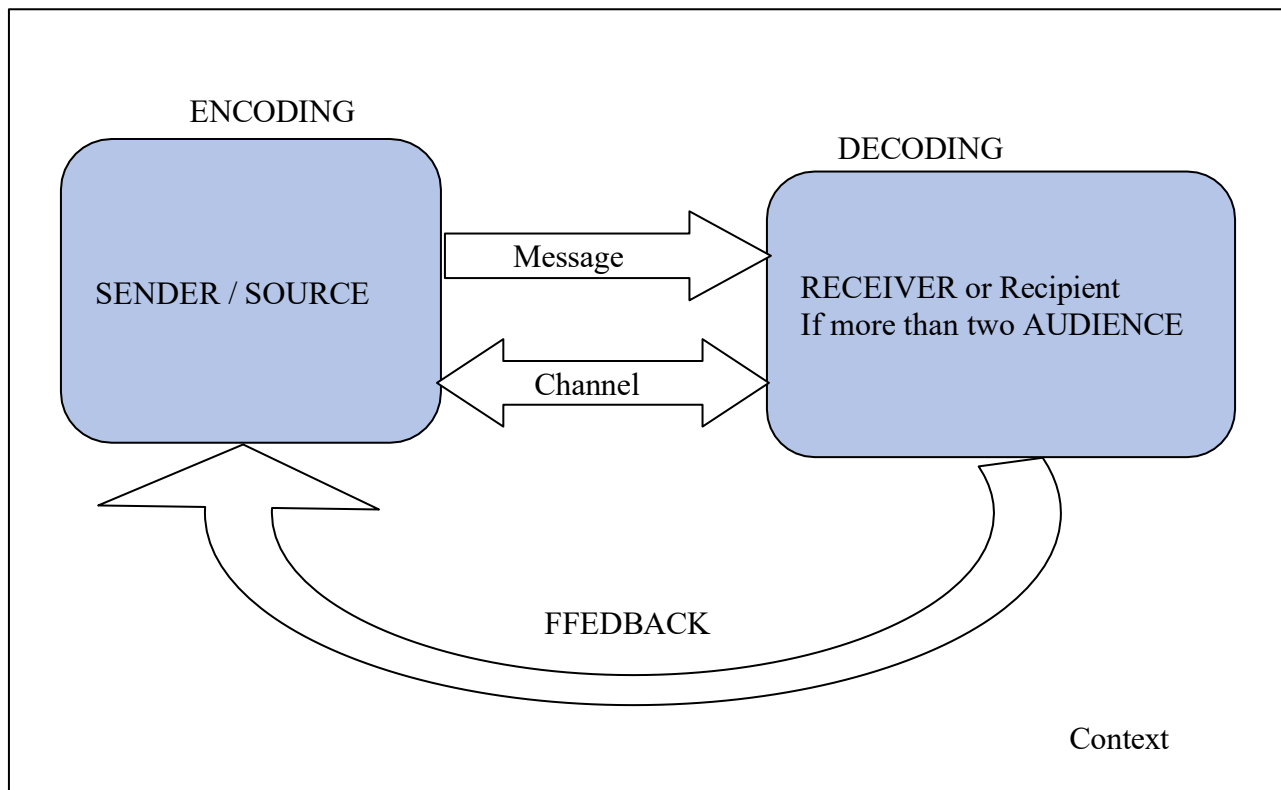
A) THE COMMUNICATION PROCESS

The Communication process is the guide toward realizing effective communication. It is through the communication that sharing of a common meaning between the sender and the receiver takes place. Individuals that follow the communication process will have the opportunity to become more productive in every aspect of their profession.

The communication process is made up of four key components. These include encoding, medium of transmission, decoding and feedback.

There are also two other factors in the process; sender and the receiver. The communication process begins with the sender and ends with the receiver. It is as shown below:

COMMUNICATION PROCESS /CYCLE



The sender/ Source

This is the person who conceives an idea and wants to share it. To communicate it, he must first think along these lines;

- ☐ What exactly do I want to say.
- ☐ What am I trying to achieve.
- ☐ What kind of person am I saying it to.

Encoding

- This is a process of transforming the idea/ thought into a message that the receiver will understand.
- The sender has to decide the specific outcomes he wants from communication. This will help him decide on the appropriate form of language and tone.

Channel/ Medium

- This is a means by which a message is sent.
- It's the physical transmission of the message to the receiver.
- Select a channel i.e. verbal, NV or written and a medium i.e. report, letter, telephone, or face to face exchange etc.
- The channel and medium you use will depend on the message, location of audience, the time available etc.

Decoding

- This is where the receiver converts the message into thought.
- The receiver must understand the language of the sender and he also makes sure that he uncovers the hidden meaning, feelings or attitudes which the sender has conveyed in the message.
- The decoded message is stored in the receiver's mind.

Receiver

- This is the person for whom the message is meant. He responsible for decoding and interpreting the message sent.

Feedback

- The communication process cannot be successful without appropriate feedback
- The receiver reacts to the sender by giving a feedback.
- Feedback is the receiver's response to the message of the sender and the final link in the communication process.
- It's the stage at which the sender evaluates the effectiveness of the communication process.
- Then the communication is repeated.

Communication can best be summarized as the transmission of a message from a

sender to a receiver in an understandable manner. The importance of effective communication is immeasurable in the world of business and in personal life. From a business perspective, effective communication is an absolute must, because it commonly accounts for the difference

between success and failure or profit and loss. It has become clear that effective business communication is critical to the successful operation of modern enterprise. Every business person needs to understand the fundamentals of effective communication.

The communication process is the guide toward realizing effective communication. It is through the communication process that the sharing of a common meaning between the sender and the receiver takes place. Individuals that follow the communication process will have the opportunity to become more productive in every aspect of their profession. Effective communication leads to understanding.

The communication process is made up of four key components. Those components include encoding, medium of transmission, decoding, and feedback. There are also two other factors in the process, and those two factors are present in the form of the sender and the receiver. The communication process begins with the sender and ends with the receiver.

The sender is an individual, group, or organization who initiates the communication. This source is initially responsible for the success of the message. The sender's experiences, attitudes, knowledge, skill, perceptions, and culture influence the message. "The written words, spoken words, and nonverbal language selected are paramount in ensuring the receiver interprets the message as intended by the sender" (Burnett & Dollar, 1989). All communication begins with the sender.

The first step the sender is faced with involves the encoding process. In order to convey meaning, the sender must begin encoding, which means translating information into a message in the form of symbols that represent ideas or concepts. This process translates the ideas or concepts into the coded message that will be communicated. The symbols can take on numerous forms such as, languages, words, or gestures. These symbols are used to encode ideas into messages that others can understand.

When encoding a message, the sender has to begin by deciding what he/she wants to transmit. This decision by the sender is based on what he/she believes about the receivers' knowledge and assumptions, along with what additional information he/she wants the receiver to have. It is important for the sender to use symbols that are familiar to the intended receiver. A good way for the sender to improve encoding their message, is to mentally visualize the communication from the receiver's point of view.

To begin transmitting the message, the sender uses some kind of channel (also called a medium). The channel is the means used to convey the message. Most channels are

either oral or written, but currently visual channels are becoming more common as technology expands. Common channels include the telephone and a variety of written forms such as memos, letters, and reports. The effectiveness of the various channels fluctuates depending on the characteristics of the communication. For example, when immediate feedback is necessary, oral communication channels are more effective because any uncertainties can be cleared up on the spot. In a situation where the message must be delivered to more than a small group of people, written channels are often more effective. Although in many cases, both oral and written channels should be used because one supplements the other.

If a sender relays a message through an inappropriate channel, its message may not reach the right receivers. That is why senders need to keep in mind that selecting the appropriate channel will greatly assist in the effectiveness of the receiver's understanding. The sender's decision to utilize either an oral or a written channel for communicating a message is influenced by several factors. The sender should ask him or herself different questions, so that they can select the appropriate channel. Is the message urgent? Is immediate feedback needed? Is documentation or a permanent record required? Is the content complicated, controversial, or private? Is the message going to someone inside or outside the organization? What oral and written communication skills does the receiver possess? Once the sender has answered all of these questions, they will be able to choose an effective channel.

After the appropriate channel or channels are selected, the message enters the decoding stage of the communication process. Decoding is conducted by the receiver. Once the message is received and examined, the stimulus is sent to the brain for interpreting, in order to assign some type of meaning to it. It is this processing stage that constitutes decoding. The receiver begins to interpret the symbols sent by the sender, translating the message to their own set of experiences in order to make the symbols meaningful. Successful communication takes place when the receiver correctly interprets the sender's message.

The receiver is the individual or individuals to whom the message is directed. The extent to which this person comprehends the message will depend on a number of factors, which include the following: how much the individual or individuals know about the topic, their receptivity to the message, and the relationship and trust that exists between sender and receiver. All interpretations by the receiver are influenced by their experiences, attitudes, knowledge, skills, perceptions, and culture. It is similar to the sender's relationship with encoding.

Feedback is the final link in the chain of the communication process. After receiving a message, the receiver responds in some way and signals that response to the sender. The signal may take the form of a spoken comment, a long sigh, a written message, a smile, or some other action. "Even a lack of response, is in a sense, a form of response" (Bovee & Thill, 1992). Without feedback, the sender cannot confirm that the receiver has interpreted the message correctly.

Feedback is a key component in the communication process because it allows the sender to evaluate the effectiveness of the message. Feedback ultimately provides an opportunity for the sender to take corrective action to clarify a misunderstood message. "Feedback plays an important role by indicating significant communication barriers: differences in background, different interpretations of words, and differing

emotional reactions" (Bovee & Thill, 1992).

The communication process is the perfect guide toward achieving effective communication. When followed properly, the process can usually assure that the sender's message will be understood by the receiver. Although the communication process seems simple, it in essence is not. Certain barriers present themselves throughout the process. Those barriers are factors that have a negative impact on the communication process. Some common barriers include the use of an inappropriate medium (channel), incorrect grammar, inflammatory words, words that conflict with body language, and technical jargon.

Noise is also another common barrier. Noise can occur during any stage of the process. Noise essentially is anything that distorts a message by interfering with the communication process. Noise can take many forms, including a radio playing in the background, another person trying to enter your conversation, and any other distractions that prevent the receiver from paying attention.

Successful and effective communication within an organization stems from the implementation of the communication process. All members within an organization will improve their communication skills if they follow the communication process, and stay away from the different barriers. It has been proven that individuals that understand the communication process will blossom into more effective communicators, and effective communicators have a greater opportunity for becoming a success.

IMPORTANCE OF FEEDBACK:

- Information obtained from feedback can be used in decision making.
- Completes the communication cycle.
- Confirmation that the message was received.
- Used as a tool to assess whether the communication was successful.
- A measure of performance.
- Feedback can be used as a motivation tool etc.

N.B :Students to come up with more points.

B) BARRIERS TO EFFECTIVE COMMUNICATION

- **Noise**

This is the physical sound or mental disturbance that disrupts the flow of communication on either the sender or receiver's sides. It can be physical noise that is sound coming from the surrounding environment or psychological noise (mental disturbance) e.g. preoccupation, tiredness, anxiety, stress etc. Physical noise can be done away with by use soundproof gadgets and communicating in a noise free area. Psychological noise you have to free your mind before you communicate or receive communication.

- **Prejudices**

This is bias and prejudging the receiver conditioned by what we already know and our background knowledge and experience. Sometimes people under look one another because of status, origin etc. (we often want to hear what we want to hear or what we think we have heard instead of what has actually been said.

- **Inattentive listening**

Listening is a skill and careful concentration is demanded if communication is to be understood. Success at gaining attention depends on the words used, the way the communication is expressed, our interest in the speaker, in the communication and other factors. Many times, the listener is not interested or has other things to concentrate on thus blocking the message from the communication.

- **Language barrier**

In effective communication, the choice of words is very vital. Many words or gestures have different meanings. Foreign language, dialects, regional accents and the use of technical or specialist language should be considered. The language used should be appropriately familiar to the receiver i.e. consider the people you are talking to.

- **Emotional responses**

Communication cannot succeed if a person is highly emotional about the topic concerned. Problems may arise from insecurity, resentment, anger, fear etc, this makes a person preoccupied with emotions to receive and send the intended message. If emotions are high on the part of the sender or the receiver/recipient, it is better to wait for a while before trying to put the message across.

- **Information overload and under load**

If you receive a message with too much or too little information you may tend to put up a barrier because the amount of information is coming so fast or so slow that you may have difficulty in interpreting the information. Excess information may confuse the receiver as he has to figure out the exact importance of the message and scanty information would make him grope for the actual intent of the message.

- **Differing perceptions**

Our minds organize this stream of sensation into a mental map that represents our perception or reality. In no case is the perception of a certain person the same as the world itself and no two maps are identical. Because your perceptions are unique, the ideas you want to express differ from other people. As senders, we choose the details that seem important and focus our attention on the most relevant and general that is selective perception. As receivers, we try to fit new details in our existing pattern thus distorting the information.

- **Differing backgrounds**

Age, education, gender, social status, economic position, religion, political beliefs e.t.c can all separate one person from another and make understanding difficult.

- **Poor planning (inappropriate choices).**

- Lack of feedback rendering the communication process incomplete
- Technical failure e.g. network problems.
- E.t.c

OVERCOMING BARRIERS TO COMMUNICATION/ SOLUTIONS

- Language barrier
 - Use the most specific and accurate words possible.
 - Use language that describes rather than evaluates.
- Poor listening
 - Listen without interrupting.
 - Try to view the situation through the eyes of other speakers and resist jumping to conclusions.
- Emotional responses
 - Be aware of the feelings that arise in your self and in others as you communicate and attempt to control them.
 - Be alert.
- Differing backgrounds
 - Clarify your own and understand the background of others.
 - Do not assume that certain behaviors mean the same thing to everyone.

N.B. Students to discuss more on the barriers and solutions.

C) PLANNING FOR COMMUNICATION

SEVEN COMPONENTS OF PLANNING FOR COMMUNICATION

Purpose (Answers the question of WHY)

Every communication must have a reason why it is being made. The message should have a purpose so that it does not affect the process.

Messages come with different purposes.

1. To prepare an organization for change.
2. To call for action that is giving instructions.
3. To provide job satisfaction, motivation and change workers' attitudes.
4. To encourage staff to develop and supply ideas and suggestions more frequently
e.g. during the meeting.
5. To develop information and understanding among workers.
6. To eliminate the grapevine and ambiguity e.g. developing procedures in organizations.
7. To influence others.
8. To create relationships/ links with other people.

Audience (Answers the question of WHO in terms of audience)

For communication to be complete there must be a sender and the receiver of the

message as seen in the process. Both verbal and non-verbal communications require audience although more attention is put on speech (oral communication). The challenge to the speaker is to be audience centered and has to ensure that;

- a) The needs of the audience are identified (values and interests). E.g. in a political rally, people expect the plans of the candidate in regard to position, in class students expect examples relating to a certain topic etc.
- b) Audience attitudes, to communicate effectively one ought to know the feelings and opinions that the audience has about him/ her or the topic in question. Calmness or hostility of the audience should be identified to know people's emotions.
- c) Audience composition; there are two approaches of audience analysis.
 - i) Getting information about the audience in terms of sex, age, numbers, marital status and experience will help create relationship with the audience by providing special attention to each individual's need. Here you get to know what the audience share in common, what they know already about the subject etc.
 - ii) Inquiring from some one who has met the same audience before e.g. a colleague, friend etc. This helps to know the expectations of the audience and its characteristics.

Structure of the communication (Answers the question of HOW)

Understand the structure of the communication and the following will guide you;

- a) How should the message flow? Words alone are insufficient to express the meaning intended by the sender. The manner in which you arrange the words should give consistency to the idea. Do away with unnecessary words. The structure also helps to delete redundancies.
- b) Method/ type of communication to be used either oral , written or non verbal
- c) The form/ means of communication to use. That is either letters, phone call etc
- d) Content, the outlook of that particular form you have chosen. E.g if it is letters, how does it look like, which paragraph to start with and what you end with. Or if it is a public presentation/ a speech you should what to start with and what follows so that you have logical flow.

Style (Still this answers the question of HOW)

This is the way one designs the communication that is the tone (sympathetic, harsh), paragraphs (short, long). It is the manner of writing. It constitutes the collective characteristics of writing or way of presenting things. To create impact, the style should be simple, informal, considerate and focused i.e. having proper words in proper places. Different occasions necessitate a different style of writing that is formal or informal depending on the relationship between the sender and the receiver.

You should know whether the message is good or bad and how to convey it. For a good message use a direct approach/ style then for a bad message use an indirect approach/ style

The message (What answers the question of which message is to be sent (content).)

This is the physical form of the thought, which is experienced and understood by some or all of the receiver's senses. It can be seeing, hearing, reading and tasting. It can further be a spoken / written / observed piece of information that can be sent to another person from the sender to the receiver. How do you convey (communicate) good and bad news messages? **E.g.** promoting, demoting or firing a person. Consider the attitude (friendly, relaxed), facial expression (smile, frown) and the tone of voice.

The time (Answers the question of WHEN)

This looks at the time. The time of communication is important. For example, if it is a meeting, the sender needs to know the best time of the day when people are psychologically and mentally strong.

Necessary resources (Answers the question of WHERE in terms of occasion)

These are the necessary resources needed in communication for example place/venue for the meeting and many other.

In planning for communication, one is trying to identify the what, where, how, when and why to communicate.

D) SEVEN C'S OR PRINCIPLES OF EFFECTIVE COMMUNICATION

The message is said to be effective when the receiver understands the same meaning that the sender intended to convey. For any business communication to be effective, it must have seven qualities. These are principles that tell us how a message can become effective for the target group in both spoken and written communication but is most outstanding in written communication. The principles also tell about style and importance of the message.

They include: Completeness, Conciseness, Consideration, Concreteness, Clarity, Courtesy and Correctness.

COMPLETENESS:

A message is complete when it contains all the facts, readers or listeners need for the

reaction desired. You must know what information your reader wants or needs and you should also be able to know the reader's background, viewpoint, needs, attitudes and emotions. Communication senders need to assess their message from eyes of the receivers to be sure they have included all the relevant information.

How to achieve the completeness

One way to make the message complete is to answer the five W's i.e WHO? WHAT? WHEN? WHERE? And WHY? The five question method is useful when writing requests, announcements, or other informative messages.

E.g. When requesting a merchandise, make clear; •What you want? •When you need it? •To whom and where it is to be sent? •And how the payment would be made?

- A complete message contains all the facts and/or answers to pertinent questions a listener, viewer, or reader needs for a communicator to achieve the desired results. Consider if you have given all the facts, covered the essentials, answered all his/her questions.

For example, when we write to place an order for shirts without indicating color and size, our message contained in the letter is not complete.

- Completeness involves the quality of the message in terms of substance, style and delivery of the message with a clear understanding of the likely reaction of the recipient for appropriate reaction.
- Give something Extra, when Desirable. Use your good judgment in offering additional material if sender's message was incomplete.

*Example: You are the president of a Community welfare center, and receive the following message. **I'm new to the city and would like to consider joining your welfare center. As I will be visiting the center within the next month, will you please tell me where the next meeting will be held?** If you answered only this question your letter would be incomplete. You should add information about a welcome message, information about parking space, date, day and time of meeting. Your message will then have something extra that the reader really needs and appreciates.*

- Completeness in writing is achieved through orderly arrangement of ideas

flowing into
other ideas and progressing into conclusion.

Benefits of completeness

- Complete Messages are more likely to bring the desired response.

- It builds Goodwill. In general “omissions cast suspicions” whether you are answering an inquiry about your product or recommending a former employee to a new job.
- Complete messages are likely to avert costly lawsuits.
- Complete message with all the essential components are more likely to motivate and persuade the receiver than a message that is vague or obscure.
- Communication that seems inconsequential can become very important if information they contain is complete and effective

CONCISENESS

It means “conveying the message by using the fewest possible words”, without sacrificing the other C qualities.

Conciseness is a prerequisite to effective business communication since all businessmen have a busy schedule hence a concise message saves the time and expenses for both the parties. It means saying all that needs to be said and no more.

How to achieve the conciseness

- Avoid wordy expressions because they slow the pace of communication and people miss out on the meaning. Learn to substitute a word for a phrase.

E.G. Instead of “at this time” you can just use only a concise word: - NOW. Always try to use “To the point Approach” in business scenario perspective. E.g. In view of the fact that the model failed twice during the time that we tested it, we are at this point in time searching for options.

Because the model failed twice when we tested it, we are now searching for options. (Are of the opinion that vs. believe; in the event that vs. if; due to the fact that vs. because; for the purpose of vs. for / to e.t.c

- Include only relevant material by sticking to the purpose of the message,

deleting irrelevant words, avoiding long introductions and unnecessary explanations.

E.g. if one of your customers requested for clients of the company in reply you should provide simply list of clients at the panel of your company. No need to provide detailed business information about client at all.

- Avoid unnecessary repetition or redundancy. Some times repetition is necessary for focusing some special issue. But when the same thing is said with out two or three reasons, the message becomes wordy and boring.

E.g. necessary requirement; Combine together; advance planning but nevertheless; past history; true facts; basic fundamentals; repeat again.

- Use shorter names after you have mentioned the long one once.

E.g. Spectrum communications Private limited use Spectrum. Use pronouns or initials E.g. Instead of World Trade Organization use WTO or You can use IT for Information Technology (keeping in mind that receiver knows about these terms).

- The communication has to be concise and hence all redundant words and terminology has to be avoided for effectiveness. Conciseness is based on relevant words and phrases only.

E.G. During the previous year just passed, MUBS had a financial deficit and is now endeavoring to ascertain the causes of its financial exigency. Vs. Last year, MUBS lost money and is now trying to learn the causes of its problems.

- Consider whether you have plunged right into the subject of the message, have said enough.
- Omit information obvious to the reader.

Benefits of conciseness

- It saves time and expenses for both the sender and the receiver.
- By eliminating unnecessary words you let important ideas stand out.
- It increases emphasis in the message.
- It shows respect for the recipient, by not cluttering them unnecessary information.
- When combined with YOU ATTITUDE the concise messages are more interesting to the recipients.

CONSIDERATION

It is very important in effective communication while writing a message to always keep in mind the target group. Consideration implies assignment of due importance to the knowledge, level of understanding, purpose and feelings of recipient.

Consideration is a very important “C” among all the seven C’s.

How to achieve consideration

- Be considerate and sensitive to the communication needs, interests or intention of your recipient. Handle matters from his/her point of view.
- Stress the “You” attitude and not the “me” attitude. This helps put emphasis on what the reader wants to know and considers how he or she will be affected by the message. There is need to develop empathy so as to avoid sounding selfish and uninterested.
- Show audience benefit or interest of the receiver. Answer the reader’s unspoken question of: “what’s in it for me?”

E.g. I am shipping your order this afternoon Vs Your order should arrive by Friday. “You will be able to shop in the evening with the extended hours.” Vs. I am delighted to announce that we will extend to make shopping more.

- Emphasize positive, pleasant facts. This means stressing what can be done instead of what cannot be done. Also you must focus on words your recipient considers favorable.

Example: •The following negative words underlined in a letter should not be there. –We regret that, since you closed your account, your name is missing from our long list of satisfied customers. We sincerely hope that given the best efforts of our fine staff, there were no occasions on which you felt we failed to serve you properly. Always show / write to reader what has so far been done in line with his/her query and avoid that has not been done so far.

- Don’t lose your temper.
- Don’t accuse.
- Don’t charge them without facts.

Benefits of consideration

Consideration helps build a quick rapport and improves effectiveness of the communication.

CONCRETENESS

It means that a message is definite, specific, and vivid rather than general or vague. Misunderstanding of words creates problems for both parties (sender and receiver).

How to achieve consideration

- When talking to a client always use facts and figures instead of generic or irrelevant information.

E.g. General: He is a very intelligent student in class and stood first in the class. Concrete: Ali's GPA in B.Sc Electrical Engineering 3.95/4.0, he stood first in his class. Always write on a very solid ground. It should definitely create a good image as well.

- Whenever possible, exact words and figures should be used rather than general words, as general words may have different meanings for the sender than for the receiver of the communication.

Example: Not concrete: These brakes stop a car within a short distance. Concrete: These Goodson power brakes stop a 2-ton car traveling 60 miles an hour, within 240 feet. The receiver will probably ask what kind of brakes is talked about, what kind of car these brakes can stop, and within what distance these brakes can stop the car. These questions may lead to the reader's suspicion about whether these brakes can function as an average brake does. Even if later messages will supply more detailed information, they can't achieve the same effect that the revision creates.

- Strong verbs in the active voice help make sentences definite. Concrete rather than abstract nouns and well-chosen modifiers can make messages vivid and forceful.
- Choose vivid image building words.

Benefits of concreteness

- Your reader knows exactly what is required or desired.
- When your approach is concrete, the reader interprets the message in the way you intend.

- Concrete messages are clear, dynamic and vivid.
- Concrete messages help make everything certain and definite, so they promote the communication by sparing the sender further explanations of and the receiver repeated questions about the same message.

- Moreover, concrete messages can also help the sender circumvent some risks resulting from the receiver's misunderstanding of the received messages.

CLARITY

Effective communication depends on the choice of right words, simple and precise terminology to express ideas. This choice is based on the recipient's knowledge level and understanding of the issue at hand. Getting the meaning from your head *accurately* to the reader is the purpose of clarity. The message must be so clear that even the dumbest man in the world should readily understand it.

How to achieve clarity

- You should always choose precise words rather longer statements.
- Always choose familiar and easy to understand words so that your reader will quickly understand it. Avoid usage of unfamiliar words. When in doubt, use the more familiar words; audience will understand them better.

E.G. you must use pay instead of remuneration and invoice instead of statement of payment

- Construct effective sentences and paragraphs. Important characteristics to consider are: – Length: Try for an average sentence length of 17 to 20 words; – Unity: unity means that you must have one main idea; – Coherence: In a coherent sentence the words are arranged so that the ideas clearly express the intended meaning. Emphasis: The quality that gives force to important parts of sentences and paragraphs is emphasis.

Example: •Unclear: His report was about managers, broken down by age and gender. •Clear: His report focused on age and gender of managers.

- Proper punctuation makes the writing clear.
- If you have a choice between long words and shorter ones, always use shorter ones. Avoid usage of long, convoluted, bureaucratic style.
- To improve clarity one has to avoid usage of camouflaged words.

- Avoid usage of cliché
- Use the right level of language
- Check Accuracy of fact figure & Words

- Clarity can be achieved by writing to serve the purpose rather than to impress readers. Understanding the subject brings about clarity in the writing.
- Logical flow of information. Don't jump about from one part of the writing to another and then back to the first aspect. This is confusing for you and the reader. Deal with each aspect separately and clearly.

Benefits of clarity

- Clarity makes comprehension easier.
- Clear expression removes ambiguity and improves clarity and understanding.

COURTESY

True courtesy involves being aware not only of the perspective of others, but also their feelings. Courtesy stems from a sincere you-attitude.

It is not merely politeness with mechanical insertions of "please" and "Thank you" although applying socially accepted manners is a form of courtesy. Rather, it is politeness that grows out of respect and concern for others.

Courteous communication generates a special tone in writing and speaking.

How to generate a Courteous Tone

- Knowing your audience allows you to use statements of courtesy hence the need to be aware of your message receiver.
- A good rule of thumb is to treat your clients' time as if it is as valuable as your own. Start meetings on time. Hold your calls during client meetings.
- If you have to take a call, never take it in front of the client. Excuse yourself and take the call in another room.
- Answer your mail promptly
- Use expressions that show respect for the others. Omit expressions that annoy, distress, or disparage.

E.G. Discourteous: Obviously, if you'd read your policy carefully, you'd be able to answer these questions yourself.

Courteous: Sometimes policy wording is a little hard to understand. I'm glad to clear up

these questions for you.

- Choose non discriminatory expressions that treat every one equally through making no unwarranted assumptions about any group of people so as to avoid offending others.

*E.g. **Sexist language** like chairman Vs chairperson; best man for the job Vs. best person for the job; executives and their wives Vs. Executives and their spouses. **Discriminatory language** E.g. Barrack Obama, the black president, supported our position Vs. Barrack Obama, the president, supported our position; Mary performed the job well for her age Vs. Mary performed the job well.*

- Use a courteous and sincere tone because it builds good will and increases the likelihood that your message will achieve its objective.
- Avoid exaggeration, flattery or lecturing the reader.

E.g. Your satisfaction means more to us than making a profit, we will work night and day to see that we earn it. Vs. We value your good will and we have taken specific steps to ensure your satisfaction.

- Grant and apologize candidly.
- Be sincerely tactful, thoughtful and appreciative. Though few people are intentionally abrupt or blunt, these negative traits are common cause of discourtesy. Avoid expression like those in the left hand column below; rephrase them as shown in the right-hand column.

Tactless, Blunt	More Tactful
Stupid letter; I can't understand	I should understand it, as there is no confusing word in this letter. Could you please explain it again?
It's your fault, you did not properly read my latest FAX	Sometimes my wording is not let me try again

Benefits of courtesy

- Courteous messages strengthen present relations and make new friends. It builds good will
- It increases the likelihood that your message will achieve its objective.

CORRECTNESS:

Correctness in communication refers to use of the appropriate level of language (formal or informal), the employment of acceptable writing mechanics and usage practices, and the selection of language and expressions that are not discriminatory. Correctness also refers to accuracy. Information which is communicated needs to be as up to date and accurate as possible. At the core of correctness is proper • Grammar, • Punctuation and • Spelling

How to ensure Correctness

Correctness should be ensured;

- o In spelling, grammar and use of language- Incorrect language spoils the message and distracts reader. Ensure proper grammar, punctuation, spelling and paragraphing. For spelling, punctuation, and grammar, you should keep a dictionary and a writer's guide at your desk. **(refer to business English section below)**
- o In appearance & form of layout- Poor & untidy layout, uneven space, tone and style of expression create a poor impression.
- o In the information it conveys-Wrong & incomplete information is the most harmful thing in the letter **(refer to completeness)**

The term correctness, as applied to business messages also mean three characteristics

- o Use the right level of language
- o Check the accuracy of figures, facts and words
- o Maintain acceptable writing mechanics

(Explained further below)

Grammar Punctuation Spelling and Paragraphing

GRAMMATICAL STRUCTURES

Grammar is the study of how words come together to form sentences. English words form various parts of a speech.

Parts of a speech

Pronoun: A word used in place of a noun. You can not say; although students come to the University to study, most students do not study. Replace with them

Adverb modifies a verb, an adjective or another adverb. Deals with the when, where, how or to what extent. E.g now, there, fast, fully, very, too, often

Verb: A word that expresses action or state of being e.g is, was, look, sit, read, should

Proposition: It shows the relationship between a noun or pronoun with another word in the sentence e.g with, from, to, for, on. (I put the book *on* the table)

Adjective: Modifies or describes a noun or pronoun. They answer the questions what number? What kind? And which one? E.g a *Dozen* eggs, a *tall* boy, the *first* lecture, frequent interruptions
Noun: Names people, places, things, ideas (Jackie, classroom, marker, concentration. Used with a, an or the in front of the word.

Conjunctions join words or groups of words. E.g and, or, but

Interjections express strong emotions and are used mostly in oral communication. E.g. Wow! Oh! Alas! Ouch! Oops!

SENTENCE CONSTRUCTION

A sentence is a group of words that contains a ***subject*** (a word that does something, has something done to it or is identified or described) and a ***predicate*** (a word that tells what the subject does, what is done to it or how it is identified or described).

- It must make sense and contain a complete thought.

Example: color blue favorite is My. (Makes no sense, therefore it is not a sentence) My favorite color is blue. (Makes complete sense, therefore it is a sentence)

- Sentences make statements, ask questions, give commands or make an exclamation.

Types of sentences

There are four kinds of sentences:

1. Assertive or declarative sentence (a statement)
2. Imperative sentence (a command)
3. Interrogative sentence (a question)

4. Exclamatory sentence (an exclamation)

Declarative / Assertive Sentence

A declarative or assertive sentence states, asserts, or declares a fact, opinion or idea. Such sentences are simple statements. Most sentences are declarative. A declarative sentence is followed by a period (.).

Examples: Jan is a student. She lives in a big city.

He sold cakes to the class. No, I do not like to eat fish.

Imperative Sentence

An imperative sentence gives a command or a request or expresses a wish. Imperative sentences do not have a subject as you is the implied subject. The imperative sentence is usually followed by a period (.). Very strong commands may be followed by an exclamation point (!).

Examples: Go to your room. Stop! (An order)
Please lend me your book. (A request)

Have a good time at the picnic. (A wish)

Interrogative Sentence

An interrogative sentence asks a question.

An interrogative sentence is followed by a question mark (?).

Examples: Have you ever seen a flying fish? Would you like another piece of pie?

Exclamatory Sentence

An exclamatory sentence expresses sudden and strong feeling , such as surprise, wonder, pity, sympathy, happiness, or gratitude.. The exclamatory sentence always

ends with an exclamation point.

Examples: That sounds incredible! I can't believe that you didn't show up!

What a
shame!

Boy, am I
tired!

Sentence errors to be avoided!

- Avoid fragments of sentences. It should be complete. (The students all busy with their books Vs. The students were all busy with their books).
- Avoid run on sentences. (Jayson is a fast worker he is not very accurate. **Vs.** Jayson is a fast worker but he is not very accurate).
- It should be of a reasonable length. Avoid too long sentences especially if it can be made into a number of them. (I fell sick last week that is why I could not make it for the appointment and in any case I believe you could not make it too since it was raining cats and dogs hence not conducive weather to go out. **Vs.** I fell sick last week that is why I could not make it for the appointment. In any case I believe you could not make it too, since it was raining cats and dogs hence not conducive weather to go out).

Proper use of Pronouns

To determine which pronoun to use in a sentence, ignore the first noun so as to hear the correct form of the pronoun like I **vs.** Me, Them **vs.** They. E.g. Jamie and me are having fun **Vs.** Jamie and I are having fun. Are Jennie and them finished with their audit **Vs.** Are Jennie and they finished with their audit.

Contractions and Possessive Pronouns

It's / Its You're / Your They're / Their

Phrasal verb

Phrasal verb is a combination of a verb and a preposition, a verb and an adverb, or a verb with both an adverb and a preposition, any of which are part of the syntax of the sentence, and so are a complete semantic unit.

Verb	Meaning	Example
ask <i>someone</i> out	invite on a date	Brian asked Judy out to dinner and a movie.
back someone up	Support	My wife backed me up over my decision to
		quit my job.
call around	phone many different places/people	We called around but we weren't able to find the car part we needed.
do away with something	Discard	It's time to do away with all of these old tax records.

Exercise

1. My parents were so disappointed when I college

Fell out, dropped out of, moved out

2. Oh dear! I've just..... the match has been cancelled.

Turned up, backed out, found out

3. Patrick hates..... in the morning. Luckily he works in the evening.

Getting in, getting on, getting up

4. I am impressed you haveso much of your English by surfing the internet!

Picked on, picked at, picked up

5. It's always better to tell the truth. Lies have a nasty habit of.you!

Catching up of, catching up with, catching in with

6. Try to be nice to your brother. He's..... a hard time at the moment.

Going down, going through, going into

7. I really enjoy college because all my fellow students..... very well.

Get on, get up, get through.

Idiomatic expressions with the required prepositions

According to	disagree with	argue with
	prohibit from	Aim at
		differ from
(thing)	differ with (person)	differ from

Subject verb agreement

Mind the use of plural and singular verbs in sentence construction. If the subject is singular, use a singular verb and vice versa. To identify the subject ask who or what before the verb.

E.g. Among the deadlines (*was*, were) the due date for the performance. The number of complaints (*has*, have) decreased dramatically. Within one block of our building sit(s) three available offices. Neither the supervisors nor the managers (are, *is*) responsible.

Tenses Present, Past, Future

- Mind them. They impact on the meaning derived from the sentence. E.g. I am working on the report; I worked on the report; I will work on the report.

Capitalisation

- At the start of a new sentence E.g I like swimming.
- A quoted sentence E.g. Sera answered, "I will not be able to make it for the meeting."
- The name of a person, race, nationality, language and religion E.g. Tracy, Mukiga, Kenyan, Luganda, Buddhist
- Titles E.g. Dr., Ms., Professor
- Important words in titles of books, magazines and newspapers E.g. Contemporary Business English.

Punctuation

It serves as a road map to guide the reader through the message pointing out: what is important (Italics); subordinate (commas); quoted or needs special attention (quotation marks); explained further or after salutation (colon) e.t.c

It aids in comprehension since it impacts on the meaning of the sentence.

PRONUNCIATIONS

Majority of the English words are spelt just the way they sound. Thus if you pronounce the words correctly, you are more likely to spell them correctly.

E.G. Twelveth vs Twelfth,

- Mind the vowel sounds consonant sounds
- Practice your intonation. Stress what needs to be stressed. E.g. A: Waiter! Waiter! There's a fly in my soup!

B: A fly in your soup? What's it doing

there? A: I have no idea.

B: Well, what do you want me to do

about it? A: I want you to come and get

it out.

B: All right. Calm down. I'll be there in a few minutes.

Practice the dialogue with appropriate intonation, substituting the words below.

Police!	There's a rhinoceros in my
!	Police backyard!
Waiter!	There's a spider in my
!	spaghetti! There's a kangaroo in
Mommy!	Waiter the living room!
!	Mommy

Use the right Level of Language

There are three levels of language; Formal, Informal and Substandard.

Formal writing is often associated with scholarly writing: doctoral dissertations, scholarly, legal documents, top-level government agreements and other material where formality is demanded.

Informal writing is more characteristic of business writing. Here you use words that are short, well-known and conversational as in this comparison list:

More Formal	less formal
--------------------	--------------------

Participate	Join
Endeavor	try
Ascertain	find out
Utilize	use
Interrogate	question

Substandard Language

Avoid substandard language. Using correct words, incorrect grammar, faulty pronunciation all suggest as inability to use good English. Some examples follow:

Substandard	More Acceptable
Ain't	isn't, aren't

Can't hardly	can hardly
Aim to proving	aim to prove
Desirous to	desirous of

Facts and Figures Accuracy

Check Accuracy of Facts, Figures and words

It is impossible to convey meaning precisely, through words, from the head of the sender to a receiver. Our goal is to be as precise as possible, which means checking and double-checking and double-checking to ensure that the figures, facts and words you use are correct.

“A good check of your data is to have another person read and comment on the validity of the material”

Figures and facts

- Verify your statistical data
- Double-check your totals
- Avoid guessing at laws that have an impact on you, the sender and your
- Have someone else read your message if the topic involves data.
- Determine whether a “fact” has changed over time
- Accuracy in writing can be achieved by careful checking and editing.

Maintain acceptable writing mechanics

- Avoid hidden verbs because they put emphasis where it should not be and hide the main action.

E.g. arrived at a conclusion vs. concluded; came to an ageement vs. agreed, gave a demonstration vs. demonstrated e.t.c

- Avoid cliches (tired, over used expressions).

E.g. of cliches: Enclosed please find; for your information; needless to say; please be advised that; take this opportunity to; company policy requires that. They lack freshness and originality and may send the un intended message

- Avoid slang (an expression that is identified with a specific group of people).

E.g. of slangs: can of worms; knock it off; chew out, Hate one's guts; pay through the nose. Slang is informal hence should be avoided because business language calls for standard word usage. Slang is short lived hence may not make sense to some one three years down the road if retrieved for reference purposes.

It is identified with a specific group of people so others in the general public may not understand the intended meaning

- Avoid dangling expressions (One that does not logically fit in with the rest of the sentence since its relationship with the rest of the sentence is unclear.

E.g. Dr. Mugarura gave a speech on drug use in our auditorium. (Are drugs being used in the auditorium?) Dr. Mugarura gave a speech in our auditorium on drug use. OR John was talking to Paul but he was not happy. (Who was not happy?) John was talking to Paul but Paul was not happy.

- Prefer positive language because it is more likely to help you achieve your objectives. For instance, employees are easily convinced to carry out assignment if advantages of doing it are stressed more than the disadvantages of not doing it. Humans often go on the defensive. It also builds good will especially amongst clients.

E.g I can not carry out the assignment until I receive facilitation Vs. I will carry out the assignment as soon as I get facilitation. The university does not offer courses like those offered by unprofessionals. Vs. The university offers world class courses that are relevant in the present business environment. Stress what can be offered rather than what can not be offered.

- Prefer the active voice that is use active sentences in business writing to show the subject that performs the action rather than the action imposed on the subject.

E.g. The class was told that the test will be on the 3rd of the month by the lecturer. The lecturer told the class that the test will be on the 3rd of the month.

- Use parallel structures to ensure consistency throughs use of similar grammatical structures for similar ideas i.e match adjectives with adjectives, nouns with nouns e.t.c.

E.g. The new dispatcher is competent and a fast worker. Vs. The new dispatcher is a competent and fast writer. The new laptop is neither light weight nor is it durable. Vs. The new laptop is neither light weight nor durable.

- Use appropriate emphasis and subordination so that the reader knows which ideas you consider most important. Put an idea in a short, simple sentence. Place the major idea first. Devote more space to the idea. Use language that shows importance. Use repetition within reason.
- Use an appropriate tone. In business writing, tone refers to the writer's attitude toward both the reader and the subject of the message. The tone of the written message affects your reader just as your tone of voice affects the listener.

For example; write confidently so as to make the reader believe in what you are saying. However avoid sounding pushy and presumptuous. E.g. If you would like to take advantage of this offer, call our toll free number Vs. To take advantage of this offer, call our tol free number.

- **Proper Use of Confusing Words!**

Our Language (Any) is constantly changing. In fact, even dictionaries can not keep up with rapid change in our language. the following words often confusing in usage:

A, An Use a before consonants and consonants sounds or a long "u" sound. Use an before vowels or silent *h* sounds
E.G HONOUR

Accept, except Accept is a verb and means to receive. Except is a verb or a preposition and relates to omitting or leaving out.

Anxious, eager Anxious implies worry, eager conveys keen desire

Between, among Between involves two people, among, three or more.

Principal, Principle **Principal:** (as an adjective) first or highest in rank, degree, worth, or importance; (as a noun) a person who holds the highest rank (i.e., school principal); financial

holding that does not include revenue or interest; sum of money that is owed, on which interest must be calculated. **Principle:** basic truth, standard, or rule

Saloon vs. Salon

Minute vs. minute

Parking vs. packing

Benefits of correctness

- Correctness in message helps in building confidence. Incorrect written documents lower the readers' confidence in the writer. In the same way, the incorrect statements and other miscellaneous errors of the speaker lower the listeners' confidence in him.
- Without correctness, readers may refuse your write up.
- It builds self image. When communication receiver finds one error he suspects that there can also be other errors in the message. Therefore, he starts searching for other mistakes automatically. It may tarnish his image and reliability too.
- For proper decision making' Correctness demands accurate figures, because decisions may go wrong if wrong figures are given.
- It helps one understand the message. Over writings, erasures, strikeouts, wrong spellings, faulty grammar, poor sentence construction etc may distract the readers and lead to misunderstanding.

Key Business Vocabulary (Refer to courtesy and consideration)

It is a personal initiative to build your vocabulary. It is important to own a dictionary and learn at least a word each day and ensure that you utilize it in your day to day

communication. However, for business purposes learn what vocabulary should be used in official circumstances.

USEFUL EXPRESSIONS IN BUSINESS ENGLISH

Apologizing

I'm sorry.; I made a mistake.; Please accept my apologies.; I'm sorry. I didn't mean to . . . ;
(I'm) sorry. I didn't realize that

That's okay. No problem.

Prefacing bad news

I'm sorry (I have) to tell you this, but . . . ; I hate to tell you this, but . . . ; I don't know
how to tell you this, but . . . ; I have some bad news.

(Formal) written apologies

We regret to inform you that . . . ; Regretfully, . . . ; Unfortunately, . . .

Asking for Help

Could you (for me) ?; Would you please . . . ?; Would you mind V+ing ?;
Could you
possibly.....?

Okay, no problem.Or Sure, I'd be glad to.

Sorry, I'm (kind of) busy now.Or I'm sorry. I don't have time right now.

Do you have a minute?; Can you spare a few minutes?; Could you do me a favor?;

Could I ask you a favor?; Can I ask you to?; I need some help (if you have time).; (If
you're not busy) I
could use your help.

Business

Introductions

Informal

This is my boss, Mr. Stratford.

Jared, this is my secretary, Barbara.

Good to meet you Or Nice to meet you too.

I'd like you to meet my co-worker, Collin

Beck. Collin, this is Susan Palmer.

Nice to meet you. Or My pleasure.

Have you met,

Jason?

Jason, this is

Teresa.

Hi, I'm Jill Watson.

I don't believe we've met. I'm Greg.

Formal

I'd like to introduce you to my dear friend, Mrs. Pleasant.

Allow me to introduce myself/my colleague, Ms.

Winters Let me introduce you to my colleague, Dean Richards.

Mr. Richards, this is David Porter from Aerospace Inc.

How do you do?

How do you do?

It's a pleasure meeting you.

Important body language to remember: Smile, eye contact, firm handshake.

Invitations

Informal:

Would you like to . . . ; We're going to Would you like to come along?; There's a . . . (tonight). Would you like to go?; How about (V+ing) . . . ?; Do you want to . . . ?; I wonder if you would like to . . . ; I was wondering if you would like to . . .

Formal:

I'd like to invite you to . . . ; If you have time, I'd like to invite you . . . ; Would you like to join us for (event) at (time) ?; We'd be glad to have you accompany us . . . ; We'd be delighted/honored to have you as our guest at . . .

Welcoming Visitors

Welcome to Cando Enterprises.

Welcome to London. I'm John

Taylor. **Meeting someone you**

don't know

1. Patricia

Murphy? Yes.

Hi, I'm Kevin Chen of Myotex Industries.

Welcome to Taiwan.

2. Are you Mr.

Blanks?

Yes, I am.

I'm Jane Placid. (We talked by telephone.)

Welcome to Sydney.

It's nice to meet you in person.

Nice meeting you too.

How was your flight?

Okay, but very long.

3. You must be Ms.

Terius. That's right.

It's a pleasure to meet you. I'm Brad

Wilson. Welcome to Suntech.

Thank you

Did you have any problem finding this place? No, your directions were very clear.

Expressing Appreciation

Thanks.; Thank you.; I appreciate it.

TOPIC 3: ORGANIZATIONAL COMMUNICATION

Communication is a heart or lifeblood of any organization. Therefore, Organizations can hardly survive without communication. In any Organization, whether small or big the role of communication is very crucial. No Organizational activity can take place without it hence making it paramount for all Organizations to embrace effective communication.

Its purpose in Organizations can be manifested in the following ways;

- Co-coordinating activities
- Making decisions (planning)
- Organizing resources
- Motivational tool (staffing)
- Teamwork effectiveness (leadership)
- Conflict resolution
- Controlling (Measure of performance through financial statements).

CLASSIFICATION OF COMMUNICATION

1. Formal vs. informal communication.

Formal communication refers to communications routed through official channels.

In larger organizations, communication becomes more formal because of the complex Nature of such organizations. E.g a written memo from a managing director to his/her departmental heads to call a meeting.

Informal communication-information is passed on by word of mouth among interested colleagues who have received it from various sources e.g. visits. This is more evident in smaller organizations with fewer employees.

2. Internal and external are other classifications of communication in organizations. Internal communication-there are various methods of internal communication which can be used in Organization. These include notices, fax, letters, telephone, memos, e-mails, face to face etc.

The purpose or objectives of internal communication are;

- To pass on instructions
- To inform staff on new policies, arrangements, developments, processes etc
- To provide feedback after analyzing situations
- To motivate staff
- To provide confirmations, responses
- To pass on ideas, suggestions

External communication; E.g. letters, annual reports, newsletters, advertisements, fax etc. The purpose or objectives of external communication are;

To provide information to consumers about products and services to do with the Organization.

- Promote the organization
- Handle enquiries about the organization and its products and services.
- Advertise the organization

THE FLOW OF INFORMATION IN ORGANIZATIONS./communication systems Depending on which kind of information to be communicated and the level of the person sending or receiving the information, there are always clear lines of communication. This is more evident in larger Organizations where communications seems to be more complicated than in small Organizations of just a few people and few communication problems are likely to arise.

Organizations usually draw an Organization chart, which makes these lines of communication quite clear and easier. The chart also shows the directions through which information can flow depending on where it is originating and who is receiving it.

These lines of communication include:

1. **Vertical communication:** This encompasses both upward and downward flow of information. Here information moves between individuals at different levels in an organization. Sometimes messages are sent from the CEO to all employees or from departmental head to all employees in his/her department only. It follows a chain of command (reporting lines) displayed on the Organizational chart. In the same way, subordinates also send messages to their

superiors upwards. However we can suffice it to say that it is a principal channel for routing directions, instructions and policies from top decision makers down through the Organization to the people who at various levels will implement them.

2. **Horizontal communication:** Occurs between people at the same level or status. E.g. a meeting of only departmental heads. The senders and the receivers can be in the same departmental heads or in different units. The common link is their need to cooperate and share. Such communications are necessary to accomplish routine tasks. The information can be communicated during face to face discussions, telephone etc.

3. **Diagonal communication:** Here there is no obvious line of authority since it takes place between people who work in different departments and at different levels within the Organization. More often than not tasks arise that involve more than one department and people no matter their level or status. It involves committees, teams or task forces that are created to solve problems or complete special projects. Its success depends largely on cooperation, goodwill and respect between the parties concerned.
4. **The grape vine:** It is an informal communication system, which results from failure to use the proper lines of communication. It is an unofficial communication system, which is ever changing. It is a vehicle for distortion of the truth, rumors and gossip. An active grapevine can cause much damage to an organization by spreading incomplete, false or exaggerated information. It can result into low morale, fear and settled workforce.

Although the grapevine has diverse effects, it cannot completely be eradicated. Therefore management should ensure that better ways through which information is communicated do exist so as to reduce its influence especially in times of uncertainty. The confidence of an Organization's employees is vital hence adequate and accurate information should always be made available to the people concerned at the earliest possible opportunity through correct channels.

TOPIC 4: WRITTEN COMMUNICATION

Written communication is used every day in organizations in form of letters, memoranda, reports, notices, electronic mail e.t.c. The secret of good writing is to use plain language as if you are having a conversation.

Advantages of written communication

- It's speedy i.e. saves time when many persons have to be contacted at the same time.
- Checked for accuracy which may not always be possible with verbal communication.
- Message usually or can be recorded i.e. can be used as a record for future reference.
- It's suitable for both simple and complex messages i.e. useful when explaining

complex matters which would be difficult for the recipient to understand immediately.

- Useful for contracts especially letters and reports i.e. used as source of evidence.
- Reliable to transmit lengthy statistical data e.g. calculations and graphs.
- Useful when dealing with any matters where it's important that a written record is kept
e.g. answering queries or making agreements.

Disadvantages of written communication

- Usually takes sometime for the message to arrive.
- Gives room for a slow feedback and sometimes none.

- Often costly to arrange in both time and money i.e. time needed to plan, write and type such messages, more stationery required and it's expensive to buy computers.
- There may be leakage of the material before time causing disruption in its effectiveness.
E.g. apprehension order may be leaked giving time to the culprit to escape.

1. BUSINESS LETTERS

A letter is a written document or printed communication addressed to a person or any other organization by a person or an organization. A business letter on the other hand is the basic means of communication two companies or between companies and their stakeholders (Suppliers, employees, customers, government, creditors e.t.c.). Common types of business letters include; appreciation, complaint, job application, apology, resignation, confirmation, request, appointment, recommendation, retirement invitation e.t.c.

Importance of business letters

- Appear formal and authoritative for action. I.e. written to persuade others to take action.
- Function as advertisements. They are written on headed paper with the company's log often the same as a trade mark which advertises the company to the recipients.
- Create and maintain the good image / reputation of a firm. A business letter on a good quality headed paper which is attractive and well – balanced enhances the prestige of an organization.
- Ensure that all the persons and organizations understand the message sent by appearing to be reasonable and fair to both the recipient and sender.
- Help to identify the company i.e. they are a representation of a company's business.
- Business letters help to create relations with the outside world. A well presented may lead to an important business contract.

Parts/ Components of a Business Letter

These involve Standard and Optional parts. Standard parts/ components are compulsory parts of a letter which every formal letter must have. Optional parts are only used when there is need for them. A carefully crafted letter presented on an attractive letter head can be a powerful communication tool.

A professional and effectively written letter is a representation of a company, so it must look distinctive and immediately communicate high quality. To achieve this, select a professional letter head design for your business. This contains the company's

logo, name, address, telephone numbers, fax numbers, email address, website and physical address

Standard parts

Letter heading/ headed paper/ sender's address/ return address. This contains three elements; name of organization, addresses (phone numbers, fax numbers and e-mail address and web site of the organization) and the logo of the organization.

Date; this involves month, day and year. Date is written in two formats; US format (month, day and year, E.g. March 3, 2012) and UK format (day, month and year, E.g. 3 March 2012).

Inside address: This is the address of the receiver of the letter. Make it as complete as possible. Start with the receiver's title (Mr., Mrs., Miss, Ms, Prof, Dr e.t.c.), name of the receiver (if sure of the name), position of the receiver and name of the organization and the address. If not sure of a woman's preference title, use Ms. Always skip a line after the heading before the inside address and another line after the inside address before the greeting / salutation.

Greeting / Salutation: The greeting in a business letter is always formal .It normally begins with the word "Dear" and always includes a person's first name, last name, title or position. if the title is unclear, use a first name. E.g. you're writing to some one named Grace Mugisha but not sure whether the person is male or female. The greeting in a business letter always ends in a colon (:), not a comma as in personal letters.

Body: The body is written as text. A business letter can be hand written or printed depending on the type of letter and the situation at hand. The body should have 3 paragraphs; in the first paragraph state why you are writing. In the second paragraph explain the situation and in the 3rd paragraph conclude. Make sure the body is written in a straight forward and concise manner.

Complementary close / Closing: The complimentary close is inserted one line below the last line of the body. This short polite closing ends with a comma. It begins at the same column as the heading does. The most common formulas used are; Yours sincerely (if the receiver's name is indicated in the inside address and or salutation) and Yours faithfully (if the receiver's name is not indicated in the inside address).

Signature block / Signature line: Sign your letter in blue or black ink

Name of the sender: In all business letters, there must be the sender's typed name after the signature. Women may indicate how they wish to be addressed by placing a personal title in brackets after the name. If any the designation / department or position of the sender may be indicated below the name.

Optional parts

- Reference line (Our Ref, Your Ref)
- Through line
- Subject line
- Signing for (PP)
- Enclosure (ENCs)
- Courtesy Copies (CC)

STYLES AND FORMATS OF BUSINESS LETTERS

Business readers expect to receive letters that adhere to an existing format standard. There are several acceptable business letter styles available for use in the professional world but the three commonly used business letter styles include; Block style, Modified/ semi block style and open (Modified/ semi with indenting).

1. Block Style: The fully – blocked layout is becoming more widely used method of display for business letters .This is because there is no indenting to bother within the whole letter. When using this business letter format, the entire is left justified and single – spaced except for double space between paragraphs. Example;

July 1, 2002

GP ASSOCIATES

P.O Box, 2653

Kampala

gparker@gpaccounting.com

www.gpaccounting.com

MR. Ernie Embata

P.O Box, 1234

Mbarara

Dear Mr. Embata:

I understand from our mutual acquaintance, Lucy Letter that you are looking for an accounting firm to assist in the sell of your business. I would welcome the opportunity to show you how GP Associates was able to help Chad successfully sell his business earlier this year.

Should you be thinking of purchasing another business, please note that we also offer business acquisition services.

To set up an appointment to discuss your specific needs, please contact me at the

above address. Sincerely,

GREEN PANKI

MARKETING

MANAGER

ENC: Documents indicating our activities and names of

successful clients. CC: Managing Director, GP Associates.

2. Modified/ semi Block Style: With this business letter format, the body of the letter is left justified and single – spaced. The heading and closing however are aligned in the center of the page. Example;

July 1, 2002

GP ASSOCIATES
P.O Box, 2653
Kampala
gparker@gpaccounting.com
www.gpaccounting.com

MR. Ernie Embata
P.O Box, 1234
Mbarara

Dear Mr. Embata:

I understand from our mutual acquaintance, Lucy Letter that you are looking for an accounting firm to assist in the sell of your business. I would welcome the opportunity to show you how GP Associates was able to help Chad successfully sell his business earlier this year.

Should you be thinking of purchasing another business, please note that we also offer business acquisition services.

To set up an appointment to discuss your specific needs, please contact me at the above address.

Sincerely,

GREEN PANKI
MARKETING
MANAGER

ENC: Documents indicating our activities and
names of successful clients.

CC: Managing Director, GP Associates.

3. Open/ Indented Style: This similar to the modified block business letter style except that each paragraph is indented instead of being left justified. Example;

July 1, 2002

GP ASSOCIATES
P.O Box, 2653
Kampala
gparker@gpaccounting.com
www.gpaccounting.com

MR. Ernie Embata
P.O Box, 1234
Mbarara

Dear Mr. Embata:

I understand from our mutual acquaintance, Lucy Letter that you are looking for an accounting firm to assist in the sell of your business. I would welcome the opportunity to show you how GP Associates was able to help Chad successfully sell his business earlier this year.

Should you be thinking of purchasing another business, please note that we also offer business acquisition services.

To set up an appointment to discuss your specific needs, please contact me at the above address.

Sincerely,

GREEN PANKI
MARKETING
MANAGER

ENC: Documents indicating our activities and
names of our successful clients.

CC: Managing Director, GP Associates.

EXAMPLE/ TYPES OF BUSINESS LETTER

Application Letters

Your application letter is one of your most important job search documents. An effective letter can get you a phone call for an interview, but a poorly written application letter usually spells continued unemployment. The difference can be how to handle a few key points.

The purpose of the cover letter is to:

- ❖ Introduce yourself to the employer.
- ❖ Indicate which position you're applying for.
- ❖ Explain why you are interested in that specific job.
- ❖ Direct the attention of employers toward information on your resume that is of particular relevance to the position being applied for.

SAMPLE APPLICATION LETTERS

7, MARCH 1999

Patrick Sabula
P.O Box, 60045
Kasese
psabs@yahoo.com

Ms Christine
Buda Personnel
Manager
Kiwaniis Furniture Works Ltd
P.O Box, 223
Mubende

Dear Ms Buda:

I was excited to see your advertisement looking for someone with excellent communications skills, organisational experience and leadership background to train for management position. I believe that my enclosed resume will demonstrate that I have the characteristics and experience you seek. In addition, I would like to mention how my experience last semester makes me a particularly strong candidate for the position.

As a promoter for Nina interiors at the 1997 U.M.A trade show, I discussed Nina's products with marketers and sales personnel from around the world. I also researched and wrote reports on new products development and compiled information on furniture industry trends. The knowledge of the furniture industry I gained from this position would help me analyse how Kiwanis products can meet the needs of regular and prospective clients, and valuable experience gained in promotion, sales and marketing would help me use that information effectively.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss these and other qualifications with you.

If you are interested, please contact me at (+256) 782924632 any morning before 11:00pm, or feel free to leave a message. I look forward to meeting with you to discuss the ways my skills may best serve Kiwanis Furniture Works Ltd.

Yours Sincerely,
PATRICK
SABULA June 6,
1998

Emily Mubbi
P.O Box, 445
Kampala
emibs@yahoo.com

Mr. Moore Katemba
Human Resource
Manager
Side Mirror House of Plastics
P.O Box, 223
Kawempe

Dear Mr. Katemba:

Dr Saul Wilder, a consultant to your firm and my organisational management professor, has informed me that Side Mirror House Plastics is looking for a management intern. An internship with your company would be a perfect opportunity to develop my skills as Marketing major at Makerere University Business School.

My professional capabilities would make me an asset to your company. For example my experience as a promoter at the 1998 U.M.A trade show, adequately prepares me to handle the position.

I would greatly benefit from working with knowledgeable professionals in my field of study and working for Side Mirror House of Plastics would provide me such an opportunity.

I would love to be part of your team. I am available to meet with you at your earliest convenience. You can contact me at the address and phone number above.

Thank you for consideration

Sincerely,

EMILY MUBBI

Resume included

Other examples include

- Sales letter
- Inquiry letter

- Collection letter
- Invitation letter
- Circular letter
- Order letter
- Confirmation letter, resignation letter etc.

CURRICULUM VITAE

This is not a business letter but a document that accompanies an application letter. Bello is an example of a CV

AMANDA SAMURA
P.O BOX 102, KAMPALA
PHONE: +256782524668
EMAIL:sams@yahoo.com

PERSONAL DETAILS

Date of Birth	13 th September 1984
Marital Status	Single

PROFILE

Human Resources graduate with internship experience in training and compensation benefits. Strong analytical skills, trustworthy, highly motivated and hard working person with a high sense of duty and loyalty both professionally and privately. Extremely flexible and can easily adapt to the surroundings without compromising with any of my principles and responsibilities.

EDUCATION

2003 – 2006 **Makerere University Business School**
Kampala Bachelors Degree in Human Resource
Management

2001 – 2002 **Trinity College Nabbingo**
Wakis
o Uganda Advanced Certificate of Education

1997 – 2000 **Gayaza High School**
Kampal
a Uganda Certificate of Education

1990 – 1996 **Nakasero Primary School**
Mbarar
a Primary Leaving Examination

EXPERIENCE

November 2006 – to date **MULAGO HOSPITAL**

COMPLEX Compensation Intern

Responsibilities and achievements

- Analyzed compensation figures for the mid – wife division, benchmarking each position with salary survey statistics and industry research.
- Created and advanced database in Microsoft Access to track compensation figures for a newly created Mwana Mugimu (infants) division, comparing planned salaries with industry salary surveys.
- Produced and checked all the hospital salary increase letters following the performance review cycle, resulting in 100% accuracy and on – time delivery of letters while maintaining complete data confidentiality.

October 2005 - November 2006 **PHENIX LOGISTICS LIMITED**

Human Resource Intern

Responsibilities and achievements

- Performed complete review of HR policy manual with culminating in a report to senior management with recommendations on outdated policies and those affected by the new laws.
- Created 20 – question employee opinion survey on company vacation policies and collated results in graphical format for review and use by Director of HR.

2002 – 2004

NANDOS

Waitress and Hostess

Responsibilities & Achievements.

- Served an average of fifty customers a day, two times a week, delivering orders while maintaining strong customer service and quick table turnover to increase business revenue.
- Managed daily cash receipts of an average of ushs 6 million and determining appropriate share levels with other staff members.

SKILL

- S**
- ❖ **Communication skills** – Can demonstrate oral and written communication skills at workplace and business management.
 - ❖ **Teamwork** – Can make effective contributions as both a team member and team leader in different projects. Have been active member and leader of our discussion and course work team at the University.
 - ❖ **Peer Counseling** – Attended a three-day peer counseling training and have been helping peers cope up with University challenges.
 - ❖ **Technology** – Microsoft word, Excel, Power Point and Access

EXTRA – CURRICULAR ACTIVITIES

- Treasurer, HR Club
2005/20
06 Makerere University Business School
- Chairman HR Club
2004/20
05 Makerere University Business School
- Head Disciplinary Committee
2001/20
02 Trinity College Nabbingo
- Health Perfect
2000
Gayaza High School

INTERESTS

- Reading any moral material
- Watching movies and soccer
- Playing indoor games like Ludo, Scrabble and Snakes and Ladders

LANGUAGES

- English spoken & written
- Runyankore spoken & written
- Luganda spoken

REFEREES

1. MR RANA SEMPAGAMA
HUMAN RESOURCE
LECTURER
MAKERERE UNIVERSITY BUSINESS SCHOOL
P.O BOX 1337, KAMPALA
TEL: 0772953881

2. MRS CATHY ASINGA
PRINCIPAL PERSONNEL
OFFICER MULAGO HOSPITAL
TEL: 0782437892

3. MRS RANA SEMPAGAMA
HUMAN RESOURCE
LECTURER
MAKERERE UNIVERSITY BUSINESS SCHOOL
P.O BOX 1337, KAMPALA
TEL: 0772953881

2. MEMO

A memo is a document typically used for communication within a company. It is used for relatively less formal communications and mainly to subordinates.

IMPORTANCE OF MEMOS

- Usually you write memos to inform readers of specific information.
- You might also write a memo to persuade others to take action, give feedback on an issue, or react to a situation.
- However, most memos communicate basic information, such as meeting times or due dates.
- Memos solve problems either by informing the reader about new information, like policy changes, price increases, etc., or by persuading the reader to take an action, such as attend a meeting, use less paper, or change a current production procedure. Regardless of the specific goal, memos are most effective when they connect the purpose of the writer with the interests and needs of the reader.

GENERAL FORMAT

Regardless of the style, memos generally have similar format characteristics, unless otherwise specified by your company. Your company may have specific requirements that you must use. For instance, a company might have a particular way of presenting a heading or may even use a specific type of letterhead or logo. Listed below are some basic guidelines that can help you create a memo:

- Memos have one-inch margins around the page and may be on plain paper or headed paper
- The sender usually signs the Memo using initials, first name, complete name or signature
- When you write a memo, you will follow a general format.
- However, usually a memo has a "to," "from," "subject," and "date" entry

TO:

FROM:

DATE:

SUBJECT:

- Additionally, you might also initial your name in the "FROM" line to indicate that you gave the memo a final approval.
- Sometimes organizations specify how to fill out the headings.

Message

- It is important that the first sentence of the memo should answer that question with a purpose statement. The best purpose statements are concise

and direct.

- Your memo's message should also provide a context for readers. In other words, always tell your readers why you are writing. Consider the following questions:
- Your memo can be as simple as one sentence or as detailed as one or two pages.

- It can be in form of paragraphs, bullets, numbers or even subheadings can be used depending on the kind of message and the receiver of the message.
- Finally, consider how your memo looks. If you have nothing but paragraph after paragraph of text, you might use lists to draw attention to specific information.

Tone

- Since you typically send memos to those working within your company, you can use a more informal tone than you would if you were writing a business letter.
- For example, you might refer to your colleagues by their first names or use humor. However, always keep in mind that you still need to be professional. Ask yourself how the company's president would react to your memo. If you would be embarrassed to have the president read your memo, consider changing or eliminating information.

Length

- Memos are generally short, concise documents. However, you may have to write longer memos, depending on your topic. For example, a memo might present the new guidelines for a specific office task.
- Obviously, if you have over forty guidelines, the memo will be more than a page. Some memos might even be a short report. In this case, you might include the report in the memo, or the memo might be a separate document, introducing the report.

Comparison between a memo and a business letter

Show the similarities and differences between a memo and a letter in terms of;

a) Purpose/ when used

Memo

Less formal communication

communication May not be written to people of high status anybody of any status

Letter

Highly formal

Written to

b) Scope/ extent of usage

Memo

Only used for internal communication

communication Both used for internal communication

Letter

Both internal and external

c) Structure

Memo

Letter

No salutation	Has salutation
No complementary close	Has complementary close
Date, to, from; can be interchanged	Parts cannot be
interchanged	Both have sender's address, date, inside address, subject
line, body and signature	

3. BUSINESS REPORTS

This is a printed or microfilmed collection of facts and figures presented in a logical and concise form. It may also refer to communication of information and advice from someone who has

collected and studied facts to someone who needs to be informed in order to make decisions or take action.

I.e. it is a logical presentation of factual information relating to a business activity that has taken place.

Importance of Business Reports

- Indicate actual performance of a firm i.e. financial.
- Form the foundation for decision making e.g. quantity and quality of products and services.
- Financial and credit reports allow organisations to easily access loans.
- Enable enforcement of fair policies and procedures e.g. remuneration of the employees and taxes levied.
- Allow identification and solving of problems i.e. through monitoring and evaluation reports.
- Required for record keeping purposes i.e. source of reference.

Classification and Types of Reports

Several reports are written in business. They are a very important method of gaining and giving information. Business reports are classified according;

1. Function i.e. whether to inform or analyse.

- a. Analytical reports are written to solve problems. Information is analysed, conclusions are drawn and recommendations.
- b. Informational reports – inform or instruct i.e. present information. The reader sees the details of events, activities or conditions. No analysis of the situation, no conclusions and no recommendations.

2. Origin i.e. whether authorised or voluntary.

- a. Authorised reports - Are those requested or ordered for by management.
- b. Voluntary reports - Are those not requested or ordered for by management but individuals do their research and present findings on their free will. (for private or public benefit)

3. Frequency of the issue - whether periodic or special.

- a. Periodic reports – Are those written on a timely basis e.g. daily, weekly, monthly, quarterly or yearly. E.g. financial reports.
- b. Special reports – Are those written for specific information or reports made on a special topic after research and investigation e.g. market research report, strike etc gullible

4. Formality – Whether formal or informal.

- a. Formal reports are those written by a selected committee or group of people

after fairly detailed investigations or research. These are meant to benefit the organization.

- b. Informal reports these are short reports either written in form of a memo or business letter.

5. Subject matter-These are reports in line with the origin of the department. E.g. Safety report, accident report from HR department or Safety department and equipment and maintenance report from Production department or Maintenance department.

Characteristics of Business Reports

1. Accuracy: Check that everything you write factually accurate. Facts should be capable of being verified, argument soundly based and the reasoning should be logical. Don't write anything that will misinform, mislead or unfairly persuade the readers. This will be doing a disservice not only to yourself but also to your department and organisation. Accurate information is essential for effective communication and decision – making.

2. Objectivity: A report should not be an essay reflecting personal emotions and opinions. You must look at all sides of a problem with an open mind before stating your conclusion. Making it clear that you have an open mind when writing your report will in most cases, make your conclusions and recommendations more acceptable to your readers. The emphasis therefore, should be on the factual material presented and the conclusions drawn, rather than on any personal beliefs, biases or prejudices (pre conception, pre – judgement, narrow – mindedness, discrimination and unfairness).

3. Simplicity: A report should also be as simple as it can be. However guard against over – simplifying, to the point of missing out information which the reader needs to fully understand what you are trying to say. Keep the readers firmly in mind and keep asking yourself whether or not they will be able to follow the logic of your presentation.

4. Avoid Pointless words: Some words and phrases – like basically, actually, undoubtedly, each and every one and during the course of our investigation – keep cropping up in reports, yet they add nothing to the message and often can be removed without changing the meaning or to the tone. Try leaving them out of your writing. You will find your sentences survive, succeed and may even flourish without them.

Logical flow

All the 7Cs must be followed

Report Structure

A report is mainly made up of 3 parts i.e. the Introduction, Text, and the Terminal section. But before the introduction, is the heading like any other business document.

A. Main structure

1. Introduction

- a) **Heading:** - title of the report
 - Name of the organization

b) Terms of reference

Scope of the report, Authorization of the report and date of authorization.

c) Back ground

d) procedure/ methodology

2. Text: This section provides all the necessary explanation of the report. It includes interpretation of data and comments on the significance of the findings. It is often referred to as Discussion, Findings or Data Analysis.

3. Terminal section: This section contains the summary, conclusions and recommendations. Its main function is to point out the whole report and make its final meaning clear and distinct (presenting a clear and unmistakable impression) thus should be based on the text and should not include any new information.

- a) **Summary** - Reflects what has been discussed or analysed in the text in a brief form.
- b) **Conclusion** – Evaluates facts discussed in the text and come to a stand point without including the personal opinion of researcher or writer. However, it is a logical implication of the findings
- c) **Recommendation** – Suggest the action to be taken or decision to be made basing on the findings and conclusions.

B. Short report

This takes the structure of either a letter format or a memo format

Approaches to organising a report body

There are two types / ways of arranging a report i.e.

1. Inductive arrangement: This is indirect, logical from the known to the unknown. Explanation comes before main ideas. The format is to start with the Introduction, Text (discussion and explanation) and the Terminal section last.

When to use Inductive Arrangement / Approach

- You must have a detailed explanation in order to understand the conclusions or recommendations for instance in a scientific or technical report.
- If the reader is a type who will fight the decision unless he/she is 1st given complete details and becomes convinced by the logical development of facts.
- When the reader might feel less biased towards conclusions and will be more likely to accept them if 1st given the analysis of the important factors.
- If the reader needs to be encouraged to read the entire report and not just

the terminal section.

- When the reader prefers the report in this order.

2. Deductive Arrangement / Approach: This is direct and comparable (suitable for comparison) to the direct plans used for direct requests and good messages. The main idea comes before explanation. The format is to start with the Introduction, Terminal section and Text.

When to use Deductive Arrangement / Approach

When your reader;

- Is a busy executive who wishes to know only what the conclusions are or what action is to be taken and when and who has the responsibility.
- Prefers to determine quickly whether to scan the text for confirmation of conclusions or recommendations and whether the rest of the report is worth reading.
- Wants the writer's point of view promptly.
- Can better analyse data if conclusions or recommendations are given first.
- Prefers the report in that order.

TOPIC 5 ORAL COMMUNICATION

In Business life, you will probably spend much of your time talking.

There are limits to what we can communicate without the help of language .Often if you want to discuss past events, ideas, abstractions (imagination) you need words or symbols that stand for thoughts arranged in meaningful patterns to message.

The message is eventually transmitted in spoken form hoping that someone will hear what you want to put across. Oral communication can be over telephone or face to face.

Oral communication is known as communication by word of mouth. Oral communication may be in form:

- A conversation
- A telephone conversation
- Interviews
- Training sessions
- Conference/ seminars
- A gossip in the lift
- A chance meeting in the corridor etc

Note:

Oral communication can take place between two or more people.

- ❖ It can be planned or incidental.
- ❖ It can be formal or informal.

WHY WOULD ONE CHOOSE ORAL COMMUNICATION?

- It makes possible speedy interchange with immediate feedback and spontaneous

thinking.

- People can ask questions and clarify points i.e. in case any thing is not clear to the audience, explanation can always be made.
- It is direct, simple, time saving and least expensive.
- It conveys personal warmth and friendliness because of personalized contacts.
- Any misunderstandings can be cleared immediately.

- It serves as evidence of events and proceedings.

DISADVANTAGES

- Spontaneous responses may not be carefully thought about and this means that a wrong feed back may be transmitted.
- Different meaning may be conveyed by manner of speaking, tone of voice and facial expression.
- The spirit of authority cannot be transmitted effectively in verbal communication.
- Lengthy and distant communication can't be effectively conveyed verbally.
- Meetings can be costly in terms of time and organizational money.
- There are high chances of distorting the meaning of the message if hierarchy is to be followed.

1. LISTENING

Listening is the absorption of the meanings of words and sentences by the brain. Listening leads to understanding of ideas and facts. It takes attention or sticking to the task in spite of distractions. Listening is half of oral communication. In other words, if some one communicates and there is no one to listen, then communication becomes incomplete.

Listening is a skill that needs to be practiced and taken as seriously as speaking and writing, for the consequences of not listening carefully could be very disastrous.

NOTE: The difference between listening and hearing is that, hearing is physical. Listening involves following and understanding the sound- it is hearing with a purpose.

Listening is making sense out of what we hear; it starts with hearing but goes beyond .In other, hearing is necessary but is not sufficient condition for listening. Listening involves hearing with attention and it calls for concentration and being observant.

Therefore **listening** is a total process that involves hearing with attention, being observant and making interpretation to derive meaning and make sense out of what is being spoken.

TECHNIQUES FOR EFFECTIVE LISTENING

What is effective listening?

This is actively absorbing the information given to you by the speaker, showing that

you are listening and interested, and providing feedback to the speaker so that he or she knows the message was received. Effective listeners show speakers that the listeners have heard and understood the message being communicated.

Process of listening

For listening to be effective, the following stages must be considered;

- (i) sensing ;This involves physical hearing of the message and one takes note of it .The efficiency of this stage will be affected by various external factors like noise, poor hearing and lack of attention.
- (ii) Interpreting; this involves perceiving the speaker's message basing on your own experiences expectations, your own values, beliefs and needs.
- (iii) Evaluating: It is important to consider the points mentioned and assess their importance; one should separate facts from opinions and assess the quality of these facts provided by the speaker.
- (iv) Remembering; this involves storing the message for future reference .One may take notes as he/she is listening or make a mental note of key points.
- (v) Responding :When you are given chance to evaluate the speaker's message, it is important to give verbal feedback, nods or sounds of agreement

TYPES OF LISTENING

1- **Competitive listening**; this happens when we are more interested in promoting our own point of view than in understanding or exploring someone's view. We either listen for opening to take the floor or for flaws or weak points we can attack. As we pretend to pay attention we are impatiently waiting for an opening or internally formulating our plan to devastate their arguments and make us the victor.

2- **Active listening** ;this is the most useful and important listening skill .in active listening we are also genuinely interested in understanding what the other person is thinking,feeling,wanting,or what the message means . It involves understanding and reflecting on the message in order to send feed back.

For listening to be effective, it is necessary that barriers to listening are removed such ,barriers can be both physical and psychological .physical barriers generally relate to hindrances to proper hearing while psychological barriers are more fundamental and relate to the interpretation and evaluation of the speaker and his message

Physical barriers would include; audibility, level, extraneous noises and sound, accent, and pronunciation, functioning of the microphone and other mechanical devices and interruptions

GOOD LISTENING SKILLS

1. Establish eye contact with the speaker.

- Studies show that listening has a positive relationship with eye contact. while

the speaker is speaking. This interrupts your brain and adds distraction to the speaker.

- Focus on the visual aid only when it is an asset to the point being discussed.
- Don't get so involved in taking notice that you fail to often look at the speaker. The speaker's gestures, movements and facial expression are often an important part of the message. Etc.

2. Want to listen

This suggestion simply says that, you must have an intent to listen. We can recall having been forced to listen to a speech or briefing that we didn't want to listen to. This listening seldom results in understanding or enjoyment. Therefore, we should always clear our mind and prepare to listen.

In other words, the better eye contact you have with the speaker, the better you will listen. There are some things you should do to establish eye contact:-

Don't look at others who enter or leave

3. Avoid pre-judgment/ Don't be biased

Never pre-judge the speaker because of appearance, occupation and do not make any conclusions before hearing what is said. Remember you cannot evaluate the importance of the message from the speaker until you have heard it.

Let us face it: We all have likes and dislikes; some things turn us on, others turn us off. These characteristics are natural and to be expected but we should not let our likes and dislikes get in the way of understanding the speaker's message. E.g. One may be biased about people from a certain region.

4. Give positive feedback

It is always important to give positive feedback non-verbally. You can give feedback by:-

- Looking and acting interested. Positive head nods, alertness and smiles all offer encouragement to the speaker.
- Asking questions. Questions that show interest and attention encourage both the speaker and the listener.
- Share information with the speaker- we tend to tell things to those who tell us things.

5. Judge content not delivery

You must appraise the content and not the speaker. Weigh the merits of what the speaker is saying. Focus on the main issues to see whether they have some sense in them. However, there are also times when you must judge the speaker. E.g. job interviews, speech contests e.t.c . Here, judgment of the speaker is important.

6. Extract key points

You can pick out and repeat to your self key words and phrases to help you fix in your mind what is being said. Take notes effectively- Don't attempt to write

everything down. Effective listeners focus on ideas. If you have been given an article, circle or highlight the most important points.

7. Follow the golden rule

Do to others you would have them do unto you.

The effective listener is always other directed, focused on the other person. In other words, be the kind of listener you want others to be when you are talking. Ask “How would I want others to listen to me?” That’s how to be an effective listener.

8. Block out distractions

Fight distractions and other competing thoughts if you are to be a good listener. Everyone has mannerisms. Unfortunately, some mannerisms are negative or distracting. These should be avoided. Avoid these mannerisms:-

- Tapping a pencil, playing with a rubber band or some other objects, such things distract other listeners and annoy the speaker.
- Continually looking at the clock or your watch
- Rearranging items in your wallet
- Reading a paper.

Such things hinder the speaker, divert the attention of other listeners, and prevent you from being the best listener you can be.

9. Be open minded

Appreciate the speaker’s point of view and accept that it may not agree with your own.

10. Do not interrupt

Never bring in judgments until the speaker has finished and try as much as you can not to be emotional

Poor Listening Habits and Good Listening Habits

Poor Listen ing Habits	Poor Listeners...	Good Listeners...
Criticizing a speaker	criticize the speaker's voice, clothes, or looks. Therefore, they decide that the speaker won't say anything important.	realize that a lecture is not a popularity contest. Good listeners look for the ideas being presented, not for things to criticize.
Finding fault with the speaker	become so involved in disagreeing with something the speaker states that they stop listening to the remainder of the lecture	listen with the mind, not the emotions. Good listeners jot down something they disagree with to ask the speaker later, then go on listening.

Allowing yourself to be distracted	use little distractions -- someone coughing, a pencil dropping, the door opening and closing -- as an excuse to stop listening.	filter out distractions and concentrate on what the speaker is saying.
Faking attention	look at the speaker but don't listen. They expect to get the material from the textbook later.	understand that speakers talk about what they think is most important. Good listeners know that a good lecture may not contain the same information as the
		textbook.
Forcing every lecture into one format	outline the lecture in detail. The listener is so concerned with organization that he misses the content.	adjust their style of note-taking to the speaker's topic and method of organization.
Listening only for facts	only want the facts. They consider everything else to be only the speaker's opinion.	want to see how the facts and examples support the speaker's ideas and arguments. Good listeners know that facts are important, because they support ideas.
Listening to only the easy material	think it is too difficult to follow the speaker's complicated ideas and logic. A poor listener wants entertainment, not education.	want to learn something new and try to understand the speaker's point. A good listener is not afraid of difficult, technical, or complicated ideas.
Calling a subject boring	decide a lecture is going to be dull and "turn out" the speaker.	listen closely for information that can be important and useful, even when a lecture is dull.
Overreacting to "push button" emotional words	get upset at words which trigger certain emotions -- words such as communist, income tax, Hitler or abortion. Emotion begins and listening ends.	hear these same words. When they do, they listen very carefully. A good listener tries to understand the speaker's point of view.
Wasting thought speed	move along lazily with the speaker even though thinking is faster than speaking. A poor listener daydreams and falls behind.	use any extra time or pauses in the lecture to reflect on the speaker's message. They think about what the speaker is saying, summarize the main points, and think about the next points.

BARRIERS TO EFFECTIVE LISTENING

If you are to become a good listener, it is important to be familiar with and conquer a number of physical and mental obstacles

- Pre-judgement ;most people function in life through some basic principles and assumptions ,so some listeners jump to conclusions or close their mind to new information on anything that does not agree with their beliefs.
- Selfishness; some people prefer not to listen but to take control of conversations. It doesn't matter what the subject is, the selfish listener believes he/she knows more than the speaker and they set about to prove it by relating their own experiences and their own problems and belittling the speaker's comments (they are supercilious).
- Selective listening: selective listeners let their minds drift around all over the place perhaps wondering whether they will go for lunch or what they will do after work. They tune out until they hear something that attract their attention and then they turn back in again temporarily

- Focusing on personal agenda
- Hearing emotional noise. We react emotionally to certain words concepts and ideas and to a myriad of others cues from speakers (appearance ,non verbal cues)
- Criticizing the speaker. Do not be distracted by critical evaluation of the speaker. Focus on what they are saying –the message rather than the speaker.
- Understanding speech rate vs. thought rate .Speech rate (125words per minute) is usually much slower than the rate at which we think (600-800words per minute) you may need to focus on using that extra mental time to clarify and organise in your mind what the speaker is going to say.
- Experiencing information overload; too much stimulation or information can make it very difficult to listen with full attention Try to focus on relevant information and central points that are being conveyed.
- Hearing external noise: audible noise may be extremely distracting.
- Experiencing physical difficulty; feeling physically un well or experiencing pain can make it very difficult to listen effectively .You may wish to communicate that this is not a good time and reschedule the discussion.
- Bias or prejudice; these are feelings and attitudes towards another person, tribe, people of a given religion .when people have a negative attitude towards others they can not bother paying attention to the message being passed to them.
- Language difference or accent
- Worry, fear or anger
- Lack of attention span

2. EFFECTIVE USE OF TELEPHONE

Most people use the telephone often to talk with friends or to make social arrangements. These calls are usually quite straightforward and require little planning. Using telephone for business purposes is very difficult.

In any organisation, the person on the telephone represents the company and gives an impression of the company to the outside world, therefore one needs to be courteous and if you are to ensure good public relation, you must master effective telephone techniques.

Calls for business purpose must be well planned and preparation is important. Planning telephone communication involves considering the following;

- The content of communication
- The accessibility of supporting documents
- The recipient /audience
- Clarity of speech
- Appropriate language and style.

When using the telephone and voice mail, your communication loses a lot of impact that would be present with face to face communication. On the telephone it is therefore important to use the tone of voice, inflections and attitude carefully to show your professionalism, your readiness to listen carefully and your ability to communicate clearly.

Planning telephone calls is simple and takes little time and yet it can save much of the actual speaking time and therefore it is cost effective.

BEFORE CALLING

- ❖ Choose the right time to call; when one is going to make a call, it is important to consider costs, urgency and convenience. When calling over seas you must also consider the time difference.
- ❖ Check and confirm the number; a lot of money is wasted in organisations each year on dialling wrong numbers.
- ❖ Planning your call; make a list of points and questions to be raised during your call. It is un professional to tell a person to hold on that you are looking for a pen or a book .Give a chance to the caller to ring back rather than telling him to wait.
- ❖ Avoid interruptions; Call at a time when you are un likely to be disrupted

DURING THE CALL

- ❖ Be courteous and establish a rapport; use pleasant words like how are you? It's important to whenever you make a call to first greet the person.
- ❖ Put a smile in your voice, remember your caller can't see you, so use a good tone and sound confident, decissive, helpful and interested.
- ❖ Establish the person /name of the person who has called.
- ❖ Try to recognise the voice of people you should know and use their names when you receive a call especially if that person has ever called you or made an appointment with you.
- ❖ Check your notes to ensure that you have covered everything and quote figures and other data collectly
- ❖ Obtain feed back and ensure that the caller or receiver understands the message correctly especially where deadlines and actions are involved.
- ❖ Close /end the conversation with thank you or a good day .Be courteous finish by thanking the caller or receiver for his time and trouble.

AFTER THE CALL

- ❖ Make notes; write the notes so that the recipient will be able to read them easily and put them in an appropriate place where they can be seen easily
- ❖ Take action ,if you need to send a letter of confirmation or inform someone in your organisation about any details of the call, do so immediately so that you do not forget important points

TIPS FOR EFFECTIVE TELEPHONE CALLS

- Lift the receiver after the 2nd or 3rd ring.
- Announce your name/company and greet the caller.
- Be polite and avoid a barking tone.

- Keep the conversation brief and to the point.
- If the caller is to be directed make sure the caller is not made to wait on line for un due time.
- If the person is not available, make a note of the caller's name, telephone, number, and the message, and communicate to the person concerned.
- End the conversation with thank you or good bye.
- Replace the receiver gently and back in its right place.
- Keep the personal talk on the official line to the minimum.

3. PUBLIC PRESENTATION

A presentation is any opportunity to communicate your point of view or ideas to the audience. It can be informal, formal, prepared, individual or group.

Presentation is emerging as a vital means of communicating various concepts. Preparation for the presentation is almost as important as the delivery of the message .Therefore the presenter must determine the goals and objectives of his /her presentation choose and shape the content and the appropriate communication style and organise the presentation

Good orators who can mesmerise the audience with their mastery over the language, subject, power of expression fluency and style are in great demand in seminars conferences, and other interactive forums.

To many people it is a God given gift, but it is also true that most people develop the art of speaking through conscious efforts, practice, observation and hard work which turns them to be great speaker through acquiring oral communication skills over the years.

The person making a presentation has to develop various types of skills. Essentially, he should be a communicator and should learn to express himself clearly and forcefully and should be well versed in using various types of audio-visual aids and necessary gadgets like slide, screens projectors, pointer, and the like

HOWTO PREPARE AND EXCUTE A GOOD PRESENTATION

(i) Selection of the topic; this involves choosing a topic you want to talk about. The presentation must consider the following;

- What do you want to know about the topic, you be careful and tactful on the topic you choose since many people don't want to be exposed as ignorant or un knowledgeable.
- Do you know the knowledge level of the audience or this topic?
- What sort of work have you done in this area

- Will your audience be interested in your topic
- (ii) Carry out research; get relevant details covering that particular topic you have chosen and be well acquainted with the topic above all others.
Get your fact straight; Avoid lying words like I'm not sure .so spend time collecting and confirming your information and be careful of presenting hearsay as evidence.

(iii) Audience analysis; your audience is the reason why you are there, understand your audience and if you want to reach them with your presentation, you must reach them through their needs. The following must be considered;

- How much does my audience know about me, my topic, and my presentation?
- What does the audience expect from me?
- What is the audience's attitude towards me and my product or service?
- What are the ages and gender of the audience?
- What position does the audience occupy in the organisation?
- What is the education background of the audience? What are the political and religious views of the audience?
- What is the audience's personal information (outside of work interest)?

Audiences analysis makes successful presentation planning, it is the starting point of the planning of any presentation .Your presentation is successful if your audience responds the way you intended.

Effective speaking is always dependent on the audience therefore it is important to consider the above demographic factors

Knowing your audience's personal and professional profiles will help determine what you should say, what you should not say and the 'tone' you should use. forexample you need to investigate the personalities of your audience since it will help you to determine whether your style should be relaxed and informal or professional and to the point.

(iv) Determine the goals and objectives determining the goals and objectives of your presentation will help you design your presentation around a specific purpose. Whether you are trying to sell a product or a service or an idea, you must you must keep in mind that you are selling your competence and your value to the organisation. You must make your purpose evident and relate it to your audience's perspective. Make sure you state the main point in the beginning of your presentation so that your audience knows what what the rest of your presentation will cover

State your objectives in one simple sentence forexample once you have determined your objectives use the T3 approach; tell them what you are going to tell them, then tell them and finally tell them what you told them.

(v) Planning; a good presentation should be well planned for example planning for a satisfactory introduction, body, time required and venue. The introduction should be able to capture the interest and attention of the audience with in the first sentence. Modulation of voice appropriate illustrations clearly demonstrating examples can all engage the distracted minds and bring them back to the main channel of discussion.

The presenter must introduce himself in order to win credibility.

(vi) Choosing and shaping the content: this can be very complicated but you must keep your presentation short, interesting and relevant. Choosing meaningful information that will appeal to your audience and situation is very important for example including statistics, testimonials cases,

illustrations, history, and narratives in your presentation can help convey your message. Therefore you should make content interesting but make sure it pertains to the goal of your presentation.

(vii) Choosing the appropriate style:

Choosing the appropriate presentation style will determine the effectiveness of your presentation

/content .how you speak can make or break the presentation, therefore ask yourself the following questions; what kind of tone /voice do I want to use; the tone or voice of a presenter should have four major characters

- power of voice ;audibility ,it should be loud enough to enable people hear and understand
- pitch ;this is how low or high the tone is .it is better to overcome the monotony of high or low by practicing .make it high for a point of emphasis or expression.
- Pace; this is the rate at which the presenter rates his words out. people can listen faster than we can talk.(people can listen to about 800words per minute vs. 250words you can talk)

The audience give the presenter 12 minutes of good attention before switching off. However if the pace is high it affects the pronunciation

- Pause; good presenters must pause after an important point has been made to give enough time to the audience to absorb the information.

SPEECH PRODUCTION /MAKING A PRESENTATION

When you begin your presentation, begin by greeting your audience and observe the protocol. It is better for the presenter to be smart respectful and appropriate for the occasion and audience

.the presenter should create comfortable atmosphere by starting with small talk that is un related to your presentation topic after you feel prepared and comfortable.

It is essential to plan your beginning carefully, there are four main elements

- Get their attention
 - Establish as them
 - Present a structure ;it must have a logical beginning, middle and end
 - Create a rapport
- (i) Know your topic and the issues .the best public speakers memorize their presentation, make notes for your self but do not read your speech; it is so boring instead writ key words that remind you of your message. Write your speech notes on index cards that is much easier to instead of fumbling with a sheet of paper .use your memory aid to enable you remember the sequence of points and they should be used to rehearse major issues.
 - (ii) Determination of your presentation message ;how are you going to present

- your message, use the audio materials gadgets, maps, chats when illustrating your points. They should be clear, big, enough accurate, concise and complete.
- (iii) Consideration of the personality factors/aspects; know who you are, characterise on the good features and display them to your maximum eg facial expressions, don't use stereo and don't be romantic. People will appreciate your message regardless of the colour, size or physical appearance.

- Maintain eye contact to the audience; talk directly to people, the best presentation is delivered as a conversation to every person in your audience, if you want to be believed, talk to every individual.
 - Look your best, when you smile, you look beautiful, handsome, trustworthy friendly and confident. Dress comfortably but appropriately.
- (iv) Emphasize your key points through repeating them, if you want people to remember something, repeat it at least 3 times during your speech, consider the power of voice.
 - (v) Be your self.
 - (vi) Be conscious of your postures, your voice, your gestures and your body language. Move around some how but not so much (avoid swaying from side to side or rocking back and forth).control your movements.
 - (vii) Tell stories, use word pictures that that create images in your listeners' minds, if they can see it they more likely to understand and remember your message. Use vivid descriptions, humor, personal stories and audience participation when appropriate.
 - (viii) Finish your presentation strong ,end your presentation with strong message .you choose from several techniques .a call to action is one of the best ending to get your audience into action immediately after your speech
Others can be; ending with a positive statement or a famous quotation.
 - (ix) Invite questions at the end, giving audience sufficient time to formulate them.

TIPS ON ANSWERING QUESTIONS

- Anticipate questions the audience might pose and prepare brief responses.
- Listen carefully to each question, waiting to respond until you are sure that you understand what is being asked
- Repeat questions before responding to them to ensure that the entire audience has heard them.
- Keep your response brief.
- Try to deflect loaded questions.
- Control the interchange (i.e. do not let one person dominate the question –answer period or give a min –speech)
- Use the last question to summarise your key points or re-enforce your main idea.

METHODS OF DELIVERY

(a) **Extemporaneous presentation;** this involves preparation, use of notes and rehearsal. It is the most popular and effective method, you first thoroughly

prepare your speech as outlined above then you prepare notes and present the speech from them. Usually your rehearsal making sure that all parts are clearly in mind but you make no attempts to memorize .this is a product of careful planning and practice.

(b) **Memorizing**; this is the most difficult method, atleast for most of us probably few speakers actually memorize an entire speech. Instead they memorise key notes to help them through the presentation.

(c) **reading** ;un fortunately most of us don't read aloud well we tend to reading a dull monotone, producing a most un interesting effect. We fumble over words, loose our pace, miss-punctuate marks, but you would be wise not to attempt to read a speech until you have become a proficient reader.

STAGE FRIGHT

Stage fright means the uneasiness or anxiety which one gets from the fear of speaking to the audience. This may be due to lack of confidence in oneself, lack of experience of talking to people, and lack of knowledge of the content etc

CAUSES OF STAGE FRIGHT

- Panic ;some people are nervous and panic when they stand before the audience, this is mainly because they lack enough preparation and at times they are faced with hostile audience yet they lack self confidence and and at times they mail fail to use visual aids which may lead to stammering
- Lack of adequate preparation; preparation for making a presentation is very important. This is because a presenter gets organised and prepares to make a selling presentation. It enables the speaker to determine the right title which is suitable for audience.
- Lack of adequate knowledge about the message .some people fail to make good presentation because they don't have knowledge about the subject.
- Hostile audience.
- Making un coordinated movements.
- Failure to use the visual aids.
- Lack of practice on how to make the presentation.
- Lack of confidence.
- If it is your first time to make a speech or presentation.

OVERCOMING STAGE FRIGHT

1. **Know the room and be the first person to arrive at the venue-** become familiar with the place in which you will speak. Arrive early and walk around the room including the speaking area. Stand at the lectern, speak into the microphone. Walk around where the audience will be seated. Walk from where you will be seated to the place where you will be speaking.
2. **Know the Audience** in terms of composition, age, size and gender - If possible, greet some of the audience as they arrive and chat with them. It is easier to speak to a group of friends than to a group of strangers. This will provide your audience with vitally important initial impression.

3. **Consciously make an effort to move and use body language** –gestures, facial expressions, tone, voice etc picture in your mind a dialogue on a real two way conversation.
4. **During your speech ask questions** if possible of individuals to maintain a participatory feeling.

5. **Know Your Material and prepare all your work thoroughly** - If you are not familiar with your material or are uncomfortable with it, your nervousness will increase. Practice your speech or presentation and revise it until you can present it with ease. Knowing your subject very well put you in control and will greatly reduce your anxiety.
6. **learn How to Relax** - You can ease tension by doing exercises. Sit comfortable with your back straight. Breathe in slowly, hold your breath for 4 to 5 seconds, and then slowly exhale. To relax your facial muscles, open your mouth and eyes wide, and then close them tightly.
7. **Double check your work** to ensure that you have the correct printed slides.
8. **Avoid being rushed or distracted** on the day of your presentation.
9. **Review the performance skills** you have practiced and learned
10. **Be natural and professional.** don't try to portray a different picture, the audience will not believe in you.
11. **Visualize Yourself Speaking** - Imagine yourself walking confidently to the lectern as the audience applauds. Imagine yourself speaking, your voice loud, clear and assured. When you visualize yourself as successful, you will be successful.
12. **Realize People Want You To Succeed** - All audiences want speakers to be interesting, stimulating, informative and entertaining. They want you to succeed - not fail.
13. **Don't apologize For Being Nervous** - Most of the time your nervousness does not show at all. If you don't say anything about it, nobody will notice. If you mention your nervousness or apologize for any problems you think you have with your speech, you'll only be calling attention to it. Had you remained silent, your listeners may not have noticed at all.
14. **Concentrate on Your Message - not the medium** - Your nervous feelings will dissipate if you focus your attention away from your anxieties and concentrate on your message and your audience, not yourself.
15. **Turn Nervousness into Positive Energy** - the same nervous energy that causes stage fright can be an asset to you. Harness it, and transform it into vitality and enthusiasm.
16. **Gain Experience** - Experience builds confidence, which is the key to effective speaking. Most beginning speakers find their anxieties decrease after each speech they give.
17. **Try to sound enthusiastic.**
18. **keep going on with your speech because as you move on, things will get better.**

4. INTERVIEWS

An interview is an interaction between two parties to achieve a predetermined purpose.

In business interviews are conducted for employment purposes to get information and give information.

All managers have to interview their staff for one reason or the other. Many of these interviews are informal conversations arising directly from day to day work but others require careful preparations.

In the latter category, come interviews with prospective employees, with employees seeking promotions, appraisal, and interviews with in a formal company performance-appraisal or management by objective, system reward, grievances and counselling interviews and discussions with employees who are leaving the organisation.

In business, interviews are conducted for employment purposes to get information and to give information.

TYPES OF INTERVIEWS

(i) employment /selection interviews

To decide on whom to appoint, it is necessary to know exactly what the job entails and what skills and attributes the most suitable candidate/applicant should possess. Therefore a job specification should be drawn up following a careful analysis.

Selection interviews always intend to establish for stance the candidates' level of intelligence, personality traits, verbal and numerical abilities or specific skills.

The aim of any selection interview is to obtain the maximum information about the candidate in the minimum time, therefore to achieve the goal, it is essential to put the candidate at their ease and establish the rapport quickly.

(ii) appraisal interviews

These are interviews which aim at systematically evaluating the employee's performance at his job and his potential for development and promotion.

You may have to complete a written appraisal form of an employee and then discuss it with the person or you may have to talk to the individual and complete the form during the interview.

This form of interview aims at;

- Informing the employee of his present position in the working group.
- Recognising good and efficient work.
- Telling an employee where improvement is needed.
- Developing the employee's capability in the existing job and training for promotion or change.
- Acting as a record of assessment.

(iii) guiding and counselling interview

It is now recognised that people's problems outside work or with in their work and workmates can have significant effect on efficiency and productivity. In some large organisation, there are now professionally trained counsellors who spend all or part of their time helping and advising staff.

Often however, individual managers try to assist their staff and will arrange confidential interviews with any employee who has a personal problem.

The problem may have a direct connection with work in which case you may have enough information to be able to discuss the matter in depth.

(iv) radio and television interviews

It is important for a senior officer in the organisation if asked to talk about a company

development to give expert technical views or give reactions to events affecting the organisation. Often your views will be taken as being the views of the organisation, so great care and discretion is needed in order not to commit our organisation to any course of action or to disclose confidential information.

For a studio interview, you should have time to prepare, making yourself thoroughly familiar with whatever the subject matter of the interview will be. You may ask for the main questions to be submitted to you in advance so that you can take advice on answers.

You must be sincere and answer the questions you are asked directly as you can. Watching and listening to some politicians giving evasive answers is illuminating. Avoid technicalities and above all, too many figures which tend to confuse rather than enlighten.

(v) Information interviews:

The interviewer seeks facts that bear on a decision. Questions are asked and answers are given.. One needs to decide in advance what information you require.

(vi) Persuasive interviews:

A person tells another about a new idea, product and explains why the other should act on the recommendations. The persuader asks about the other's needs and shows how the product is able to meet those needs.

(vii) Exit interviews:

The interviewer tries to understand why the interviewee is leaving the organization. Usually insight is given on how the organization is being run.

(viii) Conflict resolution interviews:

Two competing people or groups explore their problems and attitudes. The goal is to bring two parties closer together, cause adjustments in perceptions and attitudes and create a more productive climate.

(ix) Disciplinary interviews:

A supervisor tries to correct the behaviour of an employee who has ignored the organizational rules and regulations. The aim is to make the employee see the reason for the rules and agree to comply.

(x) Terminal interviews:

A supervisor informs an employee of the reasons for the termination. The interviewer tries to avoid involving the company in legal action and tries to maintain as positive a relationship as possible

CONDUCTING AN EFFECTIVE INTERVIEW

The conduct of interviews varies considerably from organisation to organisation. Companies with specialist department use members of that department (trained in interviewing techniques) for at least part of the interview process. For some jobs several people interview the applicants together as a panel.

Other organisations out source interviewers who are experts in specific fields. it is important for interviewers to know the post the candidate applied for and they should be well acquainted with the job specification, reference and assessment of other candidate so that they can dig deep to get the necessary information from the

candidates and make some predictions of likely future performance and capabilities.

HOW TO SUCCESSFULLY PREPARE FOR THE INTERVIEW

GUIDELINES FOR THE INTERVIEWER

- (i) Plan i.e. determine what is needed from the interviewee e.g. knowing whether he has the ability, skills and interest in the job this is done by asking questions which are relevant.
- (ii) Prepare a quiet place for the interview; the room must be free from noise and any other form of interruptions.
- (iii) Put the interviewee at ease: this can be done through the use of the interviewer skills like asking some friendly questions which are not related to the purpose in order to create friendliness and wipe out fear and impulse from the interviewee.
- (iv) Explain the purpose clearly and honestly especially when it is not apparent by drawing a general picture or scenario about the organisation.
- (v) Allow the interviewee to do most of the talking to enable him/her unleash the required information.
- (vi) The interviewer should guide the interviewee through the plan. This done by asking specific questions and ending answers when you have got the information you need. The interviewer must also handle moments of silence.
- (vii) Listening; the interviewer should listen and make it apparent that he/she is listening. He should use facial expressions (non verbal) to show it.
- (viii) The need to keep a record; record the information either during the interview session or soon after.
- (ix) Generate a list of suitable questions to ask.
- (x) End the interview perhaps with the finalising question
- (xi) Invite the interviewee to ask questions for clarifications.
- (xii) Probe the information given in the CV.

NB the success of the interview depends on the skills of the interviewer.

GUIDELINES FOR THE INTERVIEWEE

- Keep time and reach in the place before time so that you get time to concentrate and announce your presence or register
- Organise your academic documents before entering..
- Look again at your copy of the application letter and study the details on your CV
- Study the information in the advertisement and further information like job specification
- To prepare ;the interviewee should anticipate questions likely to be asked and form answers ;like the owner of the company ,when it was established,(its history),
 - Details of the organisation like what it does, or its products or services it offers
 - The mission of the company.
 - Companies that form the organisation e.g. mukwano group of companies.

- Make an appropriate appearance; appropriateness varies with the situation e.g. dressing and facial expression, smartness, hands and finger nails and shoes. Wear clothes in which you feel smart but comfortable and which are impeccably clean, trim your hair.
- Show interest for example look at the interviewer and pay attention (make an eye contact to the interviewer)
- Prepare a set of intelligent questions.
- Be attentive and listen.

- Be clear about why you want to that particular post and why you picked interest in that organisation employers are interested in people who can express definite views on why they are seeking to work for them in that specific post rather than simply getting a job.
- Be prepared to answer any question fully about yourself, your past ,your ambitions for the future (long term plans)
- Ask some questions at the end especially if you are given an opportunity. never say ‘I don’t have any question ‘
- Be audible and articulate issues with confidence and avoid using jargons.
- Switch off your phone before entering.

Be courteous (show politeness) say thank you at the end of sthe interview session.

5. MEETINGS

CONDUCTING EFFECTIVE MEETING

A meeting is a gathering of two or more people to discuss matters /issues of concern so that a conclusion can be reached. Meetings provide a useful opportunity for sharing information, making suggestions and proposals, taking decision and obtaining instant feed back.

PURPOSES OF MEETING

- To coordinate or arrange activities.
- To report on some activities or experience
- To give information to a group of people
- To obtain/seek assistance
- To put forward ideas or grievances for discussion and get remedies.
- To create involvements and interest.

TYPES OF MEETINGS

Meetings are categorised into two;

- 1- Formal meetings; these are conducted using formal rules and regulations. They have procedures that should be followed and these may be laid down in various

organisational documents like articles and memorandum of associations, statutes, code of conduct and standing orders. With such meetings quorum must be present.

Such rules include when to hold meetings, who will attend? Who will chair the meeting and issues to be handled.

Formal meetings include;

- (a) ANNUAL GENERAL MEETINGS ;held once a year to assess the trading of the company
.A notice of 21 days should be given
- (b) STATUTORY GENERAL MEETINGS; it has to be held by a company after incorporation but before commencing the business.
- (c) BOARD OF DIRECTORS' MEETING; this is held as and when required.
- (d) ADHOC MEETINGS; these are held for a particular problem and dissolved after the problem has been solved.

2- Informal meetings; these are not structured and have few formalities involved. They include ;

- (a) Brain storming sessions
- (b) Group discussions
- (c) Group conversations
- (d) Management by a group of managers who may need to discuss a specific matter
- (e) Departmental meeting

In these meetings strict procedures may not be necessary and minutes may not be kept.

PLANNING AN EFFECTIVE MEETING

Meetings account for 50-60% of managers' time in business. When they are conducted efficiently, meetings are a very effective way of helping decision making process, briefing, teams exchanging information and problem solving.

However many meetings don't yield necessary fruits because of poor management, lack of planning, and being unsure of individual's role in meetings. This entails enormous wastes of time, effort, and resources.

Meetings when efficiently organised and conducted can play significant roles in communication. They aid in the exchange of information, articulation of alternative views. Deliberation on specific issues, removal of misconceptions and clarification of concepts.

Therefore a meeting must be well planned for and the following issues must be considered;

- Category of people to be invited
- Time management

- Venue arrangement such as ensuring that the meeting hall is ready and open well in time, checking all equipments such as the mikes, air conditioners, fans ,projectors, are functioning well ,providing pens and pads etc
- Refreshments are appropriate to the meeting
- Reminding the people about the time, and venue of the meeting.
- Timely information of postponement.

DOCUMENTS OF THE MEETINGS

1-The notice of the meeting

Once it has been decided to call a meeting, every one who is to attend the Meeting should be notified .the notice is prepared by the secretary, the notice must be sent out at a suitable time before the meeting to enable the people Prepare for it.

It is courteous to give busy people ample notice if we expect them to attend about two weeks before the meeting. If the date was fixed in the previous meeting, then the reminder notice may be given.

The agenda can be sent with the notice to enable people to research about the issues to be discussed.

The contents of the formal notice of the meeting include the following;

- Name of the organisation and committee/department name
- Place of the meeting.
- Date and time date of notice
- Signature of the of the person convening the meeting with his title
- Type of the meeting if applicable e.g. AGM

2- AGENDA

This is the programme of items to be discussed at the meeting in the order in which they will be taken. Each item needs a heading and a number.

The order in which special items are listed on the agenda is important. Urgent matters must obviously come first. The position of controversial items where long discussions are likely, needs more thought.

It is useless to overload an agenda with more items that can't be covered in the time available. Either the members in an attempt to complete the business may make hasty or unwise decisions or they may continue with the meeting so long that tiredness and frustration lead to the same result. It is much better to be realistic and hold matters over to the next meeting.

Members need to be sufficiently informed before hand to be able to prepare for the discussion by thinking, forming, and seeking opinions or collecting information. If they have this the discussion and the decision making at the meeting will be speeded up. It is important for the agenda to amplify headings sufficiently.

An agenda is sometimes combined with the notice of the meeting which is both economical and ensures that people do have the opportunity to consider the business prior to the meeting.

Over the time, some items have become common in meetings.

ELEMENTS OF THE AGENDA

- (i) opening prayer
- (ii) recording membership both present and absent with and
with out apologies

- (iii) Adoption of the agenda ;here members decide whether to take the agenda as it is or to make amendments
- (iv) Communication from the chair
- (v) Review of the previous minutes
- (vi) Matters arising from the communication
- (vii) Business of the day
- (viii) Any other business
- (ix) setting time for the next meeting
- (x) closing prayer

CHAIRMAN'S AGENDA

For a meeting to be successful the chairman should have a list of items to be discussed when handling communication from the chair. This saves time, avoids ambiguity and help to guide the meeting well

3- MINUTES

Minutes are a record or written summary of what transpired in the meeting. It is a duty of the secretary to write the minutes.

Minutes do not represent the ideas and opinions of the person writing them but actual issues that were raised.

They help to remind those who attended and update those who did not attend. They also provide information needed to follow up activities and should be written in past tense.

Minutes are written in various formats depending on the group or organisation.

However the following items should appear in your minutes;

- (i) The title of the minutes showing the organisation, date and venue of the meeting.
- (ii) List of those who attended.
- (iii) Those who were absent should be recorded in two sections
*absent with apologies and with out apologies.
- (iv) List of items that were handled
- (v) Title of the minutes
- (vi) At the end of the minutes, the chairman and the secretary should sign and date the minutes.

Minutes must be be suitably titled and have appropriate headings to individual items And they must be numbered.

Formal minutes must be concise but give sufficient details to enable someone who was not present at the meeting to understand fully what took place.

They must be factual and written in complete sentences.

They must be orderly and it is often necessary to re arrange the material in one's notes so as to produce a logical account with out repetition.

TYPES OF MINUTES

Minutes are categorised basing on the format they are written in. they are three types of minutes;

- Resolution minutes

- Action minutes
- Narrative minutes

1- **RESOLUTION MINUTES** ;these record only the decision that have been reached or what has been agreed on (resolved) and the resolution passed
They are usually introduced thus; thus it was therefore resolved THAT or Resolved
.....

Arguments are left out as well as conflicting views. These minutes are brief in nature, easy to write and save time. The disadvantage is that they leave out certain vital information

2- **NARRATIVE MINUTES**; These tell more of the story of what happened at the meeting.

They have details of who said what and how it was said.

Background information and discussions that led to the decision are also recorded so that who ever is reading the minutes will get a broad picture of what happened.

They are good for record purposes because they make people accountable for what they said, however they are tiring and time consuming to write.

If the wrong tenses are used the meaning of what was intended may be changed

3- **ACTION MINUTES**; these are used where there is need to bring out people's responsibility. In some meetings items are agreed upon and members assigned tasks/duties, in such circumstances it is important to write action to bring out who is responsible for what.

KEY NOTES FOR MINUTES

- (i) Name of the organisation, which meeting, date, venue, and time of the meeting
- (ii) Summarise as you record what is being said. Leave out any irrelevant discussion
- (iii) Keep your notes as short as possible, but ensure that you will be able to read them later.
- (iv) Use your copy of the agenda as the frame work.
- (v) Record the names of the persons speaking
- (VI) Make a careful record of the people present, possibly by passing a book around for signature.
- (vii) Distinguish between items under the AOB.
- (viii) Use a device such as capital or underlining so that essential notes

and records Of decision standout.

(ix) Make a careful record of essential details, dates, numbers, amounts, quantities and the names of those receiving instructions.

(x) Leave a space for chairman to sign and at the date of the next meeting.

COMMITTEE MEMBERS' ROLES IN THE MEETING

(a) CHAIRMAN

One of the advantages of having a chairman (whether he bears that title or not) is that the convention of speaking through the chair can be enforced. This means that all remarks are addressed through the chairman of the meeting, meaning that only one person will be speaking at a time.

Meetings are about persuasion, obtaining a consensus, the chairman needs to pre plan and establish priorities, to be able to state clearly at the commencement of the meeting the purpose of the discussion and to allocate tasks.

He must ensure that he is always impartial in his conduct of the meeting even if when he strongly disagree with the decision taken

ROLES OF THE CHAIRMAN

Preparation

- Decide if the meeting is necessary
- Decide the objectives and purpose of the meeting
- Select the right participants.
- Choose an appropriate venue

CONDUCT

- Begin and end the meeting on time.
- Control the meeting by following the agenda.
- Encourage full participation of members.
- Sum up decisions, action and recommendation as you move through the agenda.

FOLLOWING UP

- Distribute the minutes on a timely basis

Take up follow up action that has been agreed upon.

(b) ROLES OF A SECRETARY

The secretary is the servant of the meeting .the extent of his role will depend on the meeting but normally he/she is responsible for the following

- Convening the meeting and preparing the request documents
- Ensuring that all correspondences are appropriate and that they are delivered.
- Carry out administrative work.
- Record minutes

© Participants

WARNING SIGNS IN MEETINGS

- Small groups show up and start smaller meetings with in the meeting.

- Un usually submissive participants ;they say yes to whatever the speaker says
- Restlessness in members, some switch off from the speaker
- Constant in and out movements

- People looking bored.
- Lack of or poor initiative, they don't participate

COMMON MISTAKES

- Lack of quorum.
- Monopolising the meeting
- Failure of the chairperson to control the meeting.
- Being un prepared.
- Constant interruptions and disruptions
- Embarrassing of members by the chairperson
- Resenting or ignoring questions.

TOPIC 6: NON- VERBAL COMMUNICATION

Definition

Refers to human action and behavior and the corresponding meaning that is attached to the behavior. Or conveying a message without using words or writing. E.g. gestures, eye contact, posture, facial expressions e.t.c.

Importance of Non – Verbal Communication

- Non – verbal messages are stronger than verbal messages e.g. there is a saying that actions speak louder than words.
- Non – verbal clarifies verbal messages e.g. saying thank you with a smile makes the message more meaningful.
- Non – verbal messages are sent more frequently than verbal messages.
- It's reliable i.e. people can deceive through words but not their bodies.
- Non – verbal communication has no universal meaning. E.g. one tapping on a table may be understood as anger to some people that may not be the case i.e. one act may have many meanings.

Divisions of Non – verbal

These are basically 3;

- Environmental
- Social interactions
- Physical Interactions

1. Environmental communication

With the environment, time, territory, design and arrangement contribute to the communication of messages. Each of these conveys a message about its occupants.

- a. Time: Business is time bound. Workers must arrive in time; work in shifts and meet specified production quotas. Time is money i.e. most workers are paid by clock. Time is power i.e. people of busy schedules are perceived as more important than those who have time for social niceties. Key cultural aspect in the area of time include;
 - Monochronic cultures i.e. doing one activity at the same time e.g. reading a newspaper in a meeting may imply impoliteness.
 - Polychronic cultures i.e. people do several things at the same time e.g. having a meeting while at the same time reading documents or surfing the internet to research for solutions. Common in Latin America.
- b. Territory: Many people consider their workspace, a table, a chair or piece of machinery, an office they have run for several years as their territory that others can't enter without permission.
- c. Design and arrangement: Some time we are constantly influenced with out realizing it by the design and arrangement of the environment. Therefore managers should be familiar with five elements of that environment i.e.
 - o The building design
 - o The office space design
 - o The room design
 - o The room colour
 - o Desk arrangement
- I. Building design: This can shape the type of communication among its occupants e.g. buildings away from stairways are quiet and tend to be secure showing the seriousness of the organization.
- II. Office space design / Layout: The corner office with windows is usually for a Chief Executive Office or partner. Inner offices are for junior executives, sometimes they have no windows but at least there is a door and an area you can call your own. The general office is for the lower echelon and support personnel. There is no privacy.
- III. Room design: For fast turnover in restaurants and bars use bright lighting and should be in a noisy place. However for many other types of organizations use of bright colours and location in noisy places may indicate lack of seriousness.
- IV. Room colours: Colour is used as a motivator. It's believed that conferences conducted in cheerful bright rooms are more successful than those held in dull environments. E.g. red is aggressive, exciting and stimulating and related to emotions and passion, Blue is cool, clear, serene and has a calming effect, and Green is light, fresh and peaceful.

2. Social Communication

The environment in which we work and live influences how we communicate, affects verbal and non- verbal behaviour. Social aspects that send important messages include;

- a) Space: Personal distance extends from one to the four feet away from the body. This is often referred to as invisible. Social distance is between four and eight feet away from the body. This is used for impersonal or business like situations.

- b) Status: Title or position communicates status. Time that elapses between knocking at some one's door and entry communicates status. How far into the territory the visitor penetrates and how quickly he/she does it depends on the status.
- c) Symbol: These are used by organizations to identify themselves or their products. These create recognition of the organization and its products i.e. useful in helping sell and maintaining usable public image e.g. logos and trade marks.

3. Physical Communication

It's the most personal and unconscious but also the most easily controlled part of physical behaviour. This includes body gestures, facial expressions, eye movements, voice and clothing.

- a) Body: There is no precise meaning obtained from body position and movement. E.g. one may cry when she is happy but another when she is sad. Body languages differ from culture to culture. Each culture has its own body language. Interpretation of body language message is more accurate when it's received over a period of time and not only in one observation.
- b) Gestures: These are the movements of the body parts especially hands. Gestures vary in meaning from culture to culture and must be interpreted in the context of their meaning
e.g. hand shakes for friendliness, peace and sealing an agreement for gentlemen.
- c) Facial expressions: Smiling is a powerful signal / indication to warmth, approachability. Smiling is often contagious and others will respond favourably. They will be more comfortable around you.
- d) Eye movement: An eye moves an estimated 1000 times during the average day. Meaning attached to various movements.
- e) Clothing: This makes or breaks a person. It influences how the people around us think about us. Dressing communicates a variety of messages to others in the organization. It reveals something about your emotions and discloses information about our behaviour and differentiates us from others.
- f) Voice: Verbal messages relate to vocal factors like tone, quality, and style, rate of speech or accents. Voices discuss many messages. The sensitive strive to use a voice that complements and emphasizes the words that he/she speaks.
- g) Touch
- h) Physical appearance of the body

Problems Associated With Non-verbal communication

- Differences in interpretation. Each person may interpret it according to background, knowledge and experience.
- Can't be stored.
- No consistency in meaning i.e. unique from society to society. E.g. nodding means yes to a Ugandan but no to Japanese.
- May not be complete for effectiveness.
- May contradict the verbal communication e.g. I'm happy to receive, yet the attitude or body language is not friendly.

- It's applicable when there is along distance between the communicators.
- Highly influenced by the personality of the communicator and receiver in question.